

Current Affairs MCQs PDF - April, 2026



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1. The Kariba Dam, where a 500 MW floating solar plant is being planned, is located on which river?

- [A] Nile River
- [B] Congo River
- [C] Zambezi River
- [D] Niger River

Answer: Zambezi River

A 500 MW floating solar plant is being planned at Kariba Dam by Green Hybrid Power in partnership with Intensive Energy User Group. The dam is located on the Zambezi River at the Kariba Gorge, forming the boundary between Zambia and Zimbabwe. It is a double-curvature concrete arch dam, completed in 1959, and stands about 128 metres high. The dam plays a crucial role in power generation, supplying electricity to both Zambia and Zimbabwe. Its construction led to the creation of Lake Kariba, the world's largest human-made lake by volume.

2. Agray, an anti-submarine warfare shallow water craft, has been indigenously designed and built by which shipyard?

- [A] Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- [B] Cochin Shipyard Limited
- [C] Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers
- [D] Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers

Agray, an anti-submarine warfare shallow water craft, has been delivered to the Indian Navy. It is the fourth of eight ASW Shallow Water Crafts, aimed at strengthening coastal defence capabilities. The vessel is indigenously designed and built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers. It is a reincarnation of the earlier INS Agray, a patrol vessel decommissioned in 2017. The ship has been constructed as per standards of the Indian Register of Shipping. It uses waterjet propulsion, making it among the largest Indian naval warships to use this technology. It is equipped with lightweight torpedoes, indigenous rocket launchers, and advanced shallow water SONAR systems for effective submarine detection.

3. Which city is the host of World Buddhist Peace Conference 2026?

- [A] Hyderabad
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Mumbai
- [D] Bhopal

**Answer: Hyderabad**

Hyderabad hosted the inaugural World Buddhist Peace Conference 2026, bringing together ministers, monks, scholars, and delegates from over 20 countries. It aims to advance dialogue on peace, reconciliation, and ethical leadership. The event is part of a global initiative to position Telangana as a centre for Buddhist heritage diplomacy and peace-building. The summit focused on Buddhist approaches to conflict resolution, reconciliation, and healing.

4. The Celeste mission is associated with which space agency?

- [A] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- [B] Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)
- [C] European Space Agency (ESA)
- [D] National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)

Answer: European Space Agency (ESA)

In March 2026, the European Space Agency (ESA) launched the first two satellites, IOD-1 and IOD-2, of its Celeste mission from Rocket Lab, New Zealand. The Celeste mission is an in-orbit demonstration designed to test low Earth orbit (LEO) positioning, navigation, and timing technologies. It aims to complement Europe's existing Galileo (Medium Earth Orbit) and EGNOS (Geostationary Navigation Overlay) systems. The mission represents a shift towards a multi-layered navigation architecture for Europe. The satellites were launched on March 28, 2026, aboard a Rocket Lab Electron rocket.

5. Which state is the host of 16th Hockey India Sub Junior Women National Championship 2026?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Jharkhand
- [D] Bihar

Answer: Jharkhand

The 16th Hockey India Sub Junior Women National Championship 2026 starts from 1 April, in Ranchi, Jharkhand, and run until April 12. The tournament follows a division-based format to boost competition and player development. Division 'A' has 12 teams in four pools, with knockouts from April 9 and the final on April 12. Divisions 'B' and 'C' will be played in league formats from April 1–6 and April 1–4, respectively. All matches will take place at the Marang Gomke Jaipal Singh Astroturf Hockey Stadium.

6. What is the objective of tri service joint military exercise "Dweep Shakti" conducted in March 2026?

- [A] Cyber warfare capability
- [B] Mountain warfare preparedness
- [C] Integrated rapid response for coastal and island defence
- [D] Space-based defence systems

Answer: Integrated rapid response for coastal and island defence

The Tri-Service exercise "Dweep Shakti" was conducted jointly by the Indian Army, Indian Navy, and Indian Air Force from March 24 to March 28. The exercise aimed to validate



integrated capabilities for rapid response in coastal and island defence operations. It involved coordinated amphibious assaults, maritime dominance operations, and complex beach landing drills. Advanced next-generation equipment and drones were used, highlighting improved precision and interoperability among the three services. The exercise helped refine integrated tactics, techniques, and procedures, strengthening multi-domain operational capability.

7. Bhavasagara Referral Centre, which was designated as a National Repository for Deep-Sea Fauna, is located in which city?

- [A] Chennai
- [B] Kochi
- [C] Visakhapatnam
- [D] Bengaluru

Answer: Kochi

The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has designated the Bhavasagara Referral Centre as a National Repository for Deep-Sea Fauna under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002. The centre is located at the Centre for Marine Living Resources and Ecology in Kochi and functions under the Ministry of Earth Sciences. It will act as a national facility for preserving, studying, and documenting India's deep-sea biodiversity. The initiative strengthens India's focus on the blue economy and marine biodiversity conservation.

8. Which state government has launched Mukh Mantri Mawan Dheeyan Satkar Yojana (MMMDSY)?

- [A] Punjab
- [B] Haryana
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Punjab

The Punjab Cabinet has approved a women-centric scheme named Mukh Mantri Mawan Dheeyan Satkar Yojana (MMMDSY) to provide direct financial support to women. The scheme has a budget allocation of ₹9,300 crore for FY 2026–27, reflecting a major welfare initiative by the state. It is a Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) scheme, ensuring funds are directly credited to beneficiaries' bank accounts. It is expected to cover around 97% of adult women, including those aged 18 years and above and registered as voters in Punjab.

9. What is the name of the platform developed by students from Jaipur to help defence families access government schemes?

- [A] Veer Setu
- [B] Sainik Sahay
- [C] Veer Sahara
- [D] Rakshabandhan portal

Answer: Veer Sahara

Students from Jayshree Periwal International School, Jaipur, developed the Veer Sahara App, a digital platform to connect defence families with government welfare schemes. The app uses a step-by-step form and AI-assisted voice guidance to help users easily navigate



the process. It identifies relevant schemes and awards based on user input and provides direct application links. It aims to support ex-servicemen, widows, dependents, and families of martyrs by reducing complexity, delays, and dependence on intermediaries.

10. Which state has launched the “Amaravati Quantum Valley (AQV)” initiative?

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Andhra Pradesh

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu unveiled a plan to develop Amaravati as a global hub for quantum computing. The initiative, Amaravati Quantum Valley (AQV), aims to place Andhra Pradesh among the top 5 global quantum hubs by 2030, leveraging the National Quantum Mission. The first quantum computer is set to be launched on April 14, marking a major milestone. The ecosystem will include hardware manufacturing, algorithm development, research, and innovation labs, supported by 8 dedicated research towers. The state plans to develop core technologies locally (cryogenics, photonics, advanced electronics) to reduce import dependence and achieve end-to-end capabilities.

11. Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) for the insurance sector has been introduced by which organization?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India
- [C] Reserve Bank of India
- [D] Securities and Exchange Board of India

Answer: Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India has recently introduced Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) for the insurance sector to modernise financial reporting practices. Ind AS were originally notified in 2015 by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and are largely converged with the International Financial Reporting Standards, thereby aligning India’s accounting system with global norms. These standards follow a principle-based approach, focusing on fair value measurement, improved transparency, and enhanced financial disclosures, which helps in better decision-making and comparability.

12. Malwan-Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft has been designed and constructed by which shipyard?

- [A] Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- [B] Cochin Shipyard Limited
- [C] Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- [D] Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: Cochin Shipyard Limited

The Malwan has been delivered to the Indian Navy as part of efforts to strengthen coastal defence capabilities. It is the second of eight Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Crafts



(ASW SWC) being built by Cochin Shipyard Limited at Kochi, and is indigenously designed and constructed. The vessel is named after Malwan and carries forward the legacy of the former INS Malwan, a naval minesweeper that served until 2003. It is designed for Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW), coastal surveillance, Low Intensity Maritime Operations (LIMO), and mine warfare.

13. The INSPIRE Scheme is implemented by which department?

- [A] Department of Science and Technology
- [B] Department of Finance
- [C] Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances
- [D] Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade

Answer: Department of Science and Technology

The INSPIRE Scheme (Innovation in Science Pursuit for Inspired Research), implemented by the Department of Science and Technology, aims to attract meritorious youth to pursue basic and natural sciences and strengthen India's Research & Development base. The scheme has supported large numbers of students in recent years, with INSPIRE-MANAK beneficiaries around 50,000 annually, while INSPIRE-SHE supports nearly 9,000–10,000 students per year.

14. The SHe-Box Portal was launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Labour and Employment
- [C] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [D] Ministry of Law and Justice

Answer: Ministry of Women and Child Development

The SHe-Box Portal (Sexual Harassment Electronic Box) was launched on 29 August 2024 by the Ministry of Women and Child Development to strengthen implementation of the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act. As of March 2026, over 1.61 lakh workplaces (public and private) have been onboarded, with details of 68,460 Internal Committees (ICs) and 777 Local Committees (LCs) available on the portal. The portal helps in digital monitoring, complaint handling, and compliance tracking related to workplace sexual harassment cases.

15. MAATI-9' Festival is associated with which region?

- [A] Awadh
- [B] Bundelkhand
- [C] Purvanchal
- [D] Malwa

Answer: Purvanchal

The Purvanchal Mahotsav 'Maati-9' is a major cultural festival of the Purvanchal region, centred on the theme of "Maati" (soil), symbolising the deep connection between people and their roots. It showcases the region's rich cultural and spiritual heritage through art, cuisine, tourism, and traditional practices. The festival is organised with participation from cultural groups, artisans, and local communities, reflecting the diversity of Purvanchal. Its



key objectives are to preserve and promote regional heritage and to strengthen the connection of youth with their traditions and identity.

16. Mahi Banswara Atomic Nuclear Power Project is located in which state?

- [A] Rajasthan
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Tamil Nadu
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Rajasthan

Atomic Energy Regulatory Board approved excavation for Units 1 & 2 of Mahi Banswara Rajasthan Atomic Nuclear Power Project. It is located in Banswara, Rajasthan, near Mahi Dam on Mahi River. It is developed by Anushakti Vidhyut Nigam Limited, a joint venture of Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited and National Thermal Power Corporation Limited. It is part of India's "fleet mode" initiative—standardized construction of 10 identical 700 megawatt reactors for efficiency.

17. Which state government passed the Gig Workers Bill in April 2026?

- [A] Punjab
- [B] Uttar Pradesh
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Telangana

Answer: Telangana

Telangana government passed the Platform-Based Gig Workers (Registration, Social Security and Welfare) Bill in April 2026 to regulate gig work and ensure welfare. The bill provides for a welfare board, aggregator levy, unique identification for workers, and penalties for non-compliance. It aligns with provisions of Code on Social Security, 2020 recognizing gig workers. The initiative addresses issues like income insecurity, lack of social protection, and financial exclusion. Similar legislation has been enacted in states like Karnataka, Rajasthan, Jharkhand, and Bihar.

18. What is the primary objective of the Remotely Piloted Strike Aircraft (RPSA) programme?

- [A] Develop supersonic passenger aircraft
- [B] Develop unmanned combat aerial vehicles
- [C] Improve air traffic management systems
- [D] Build satellite launch vehicles

Answer: Develop unmanned combat aerial vehicles

Indian Air Force is preparing to induct unmanned stealth fighters under the Remotely Piloted Strike Aircraft (RPSA) programme. RPSA aims to develop Unmanned Combat Aerial Vehicle (UCAV) named Ghatak UCAV. Unmanned Combat Aerial Vehicles carry missiles and bombs for autonomous strike and combat operations. Ghatak features a stealthy flying-wing design for low radar detection. It can conduct deep-strike missions in heavily defended airspace without risking pilots.

19. What is the IUCN conservation status of Sloth bear that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Critically Endangered



- [B] Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Vulnerable

Sloth Bear was recently captured by forest officials near Shivamogga after straying into villages. It is one of the eight bear species globally and is myrmecophagous, feeding mainly on ants and termites. It inhabits dry and moist forests and grasslands with rocks and shrubs for shelter. It is found in India, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Bhutan and is mostly nocturnal. Important habitats include Daroji Sloth Bear Sanctuary and Jessore Sloth Bear Sanctuary. According to International Union for Conservation of Nature, its conservation status is Vulnerable.

20. The Centre for Southeast Asian Studies has been inaugurated at which university?

- [A] Jawaharlal Nehru University
- [B] Banaras Hindu University
- [C] Delhi University
- [D] Nalanda University

Answer: Nalanda University

The Centre for Southeast Asian Studies has been inaugurated at Nalanda University to strengthen India's engagement with Southeast Asia. The initiative was announced by Narendra Modi during the ASEAN-India Summit 2025. It focuses on interdisciplinary research areas like climate, maritime studies, trade, public health, migration, and digital cooperation. The Centre will support the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership Plan of Action (2026–2030). It aims to act as a bridge by enhancing academic collaboration, policy engagement, and cultural ties between India and Southeast Asia.

21. Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies (RoSCTL) Scheme is related to which sector?

- [A] Agriculture
- [B] Textile
- [C] IT Services
- [D] Banking

Answer: Textile

The Ministry of Textiles has extended the Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies (RoSCTL) Scheme for exports of apparel, garments, and made-ups up to 30th September 2026 to promote textile exports. The RoSCTL Scheme has been operational since 2019 and aims to enhance the competitiveness of Indian textile exports in the global market. The scheme provides reimbursement of all embedded State and Central taxes and levies that are not otherwise refunded under any other mechanism. The RoSCTL Scheme was introduced as a successor to the Rebate of State Levies (RoSL) Scheme, which covered only State taxes and levies.

22. The Central Government has recently mandated petrol pumps to supply E20 fuel. What does E20 fuel represent?

- [A] 20% petrol + 80% ethanol



- [B] 20% ethanol + 80% petrol
- [C] 50% ethanol + 50% petrol
- [D] 100% ethanol

Answer: 20% ethanol + 80% petrol

The Central Government has mandated petrol pumps to supply E20 fuel with a minimum octane rating of 95 RON to promote cleaner and more efficient fuel usage. E20 fuel is a blended fuel consisting of 20% ethanol and 80% petrol, aimed at reducing dependence on fossil fuels. Ethanol used in E20 is a biofuel derived from renewable crops such as sugarcane, maize, and grains, making it environmentally sustainable. E20 fuel has a higher octane rating (minimum 95 RON) compared to regular petrol in India, which typically has an octane rating of 91–92 RON.

23. Rice's whale, that was recently seen in news, is endemic to which region?

- [A] Europe
- [B] South Africa
- [C] Australia
- [D] Gulf of Mexico

Answer: Gulf of Mexico

Rice's Whale is a baleen whale belonging to the family Balaenopteridae and is closely related to Bryde's whales. It was recognised as a distinct species in 2021, separate from other Bryde's whales globally. It is the only whale species found year-round in the Gulf of Mexico. Its diet mainly consists of silver-rag driftfish. Major threats include oil drilling, vessel strikes, noise pollution, oil spills, and climate change. According to International Union for Conservation of Nature, it is classified as Critically Endangered.

24. Which Indian player has been declared as the outstanding Men's Player of the Year 2025 by the Asian Squash Federation (ASF)?

- [A] Saurav Ghosal
- [B] Senthil Kumar
- [C] Ramit Tandon
- [D] Abhay Singh

Answer: Abhay Singh

Asian Squash Federation named Abhay Singh as Men's Player of the Year 2025. Anahat Singh won the top honour in the girls (junior) category. The Indian boys team won the Men's Team Award after securing bronze at the World Junior Team Championships 2025. Previously, Saurav Ghosal and Joshna Chinappa won ASF awards in 2022.

25. Uchral Nyam-Osor has been appointed as new prime minister of which country?

- [A] Nigeria
- [B] Egypt
- [C] Mongolia
- [D] Kenya

Answer: Mongolia

Mongolia parliament appointed Uchral Nyam-Osor as the new Prime Minister, the third in



nine months. He replaced Zandanshatar Gombojav, who resigned amid political deadlock and party conflicts. Uchral secured 88 out of 107 votes and promised bureaucratic reforms and price stabilisation.

26. Which country launched the ICP mobile app to help identify venomous snakes and improve public awareness?

- [A] Brazil
- [B] Mexico
- [C] Costa Rica
- [D] Colombia

Answer: Costa Rica

Costa Rica launched the ICP mobile app to help identify venomous snakes and improve public awareness. The app is developed by Universidad de Costa Rica through the Clodomiro Picado Institute. It enables identification of 25 venomous snake species using images and scientific descriptions. The app provides first-aid guidance for snakebites and safety instructions for users. It also allows users to record geographic location of snake encounters to assist medical response. The initiative addresses frequent misidentification and reduces unnecessary killing of non-venomous snakes. The app is freely available on Android and iOS, promoting accessible public health information.

27. Which state/UT government launched 'Lakhpati Bitiya Yojana' to support girls' education?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Delhi
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Jammu and Kashmir

Answer: Delhi

The Delhi government has launched the Lakhpati Bitiya Yojana, a financial empowerment scheme providing up to ₹1.2 lakh (inclusive of interest) to girls from birth through graduation to support their education and prevent early marriage. The scheme, aimed at low-income families, provides phase-wise payments, with maturity at age 18 or 21. The scheme becomes fully operational on April 1, 2026.

28. What is the IUCN conservation status of 'Snowy Owl' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Vulnerable

Snowy Owl has been granted international protection under the U.N. Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals. It is a large white owl of the true owl family, mainly inhabiting Arctic tundra regions. It is found across Arctic areas of North America and Eurasia, and also in open habitats like grasslands and coastal dunes. Unlike most owls, it is active during both day and night and shows nomadic behaviour. It feeds on small mammals like lemmings and voles using a swooping hunting technique.



According to International Union for Conservation of Nature, it is classified as Vulnerable.

29. World Aquatic Animal Day is celebrated annually on which day?

- [A] April 1
- [B] April 2
- [C] April 3
- [D] April 4

Answer: April 3

World Aquatic Animal Day is celebrated annually on April 3rd. The day was founded in 2020 by the Animal Law Clinic at Lewis & Clark Law School. This day aims to raise awareness about the protection of all creatures living in water, highlighting threats like pollution, climate change, and overfishing.

30. Molucca Sea, that was recently seen in news, is located in which ocean?

- [A] Atlantic Ocean
- [B] Arctic Ocean
- [C] Pacific Ocean
- [D] Indian Ocean

Answer: Pacific Ocean

A magnitude 7.6 earthquake struck Indonesia's Northern Molucca Sea, causing damage, one death, tsunami waves, and multiple aftershocks. Molucca Sea is located in the western Pacific Ocean within the Indonesian archipelago. It is bounded by Sulawesi to the west, Halmahera to the east, the Sula Islands to the south, and connects northward to the Philippine Sea. The sea lies over the Molucca Sea Plate, which experiences Divergent Double Subduction — subducting westwards under the Eurasian (Sangihe) Plate and eastwards under the Philippine Sea (Halmahera) Plate. It is a highly active seismic region with frequent earthquakes and crustal movements.

31. Gangotri National Park is located in which state?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Himachal Pradesh
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Uttarakhand

Gangotri National Park recently reopened after a six-month winter break, highlighting seasonal conservation management in the Himalayan region. It is located in Uttarakhand, along the upper catchment of the Bhagirathi River. The park's northeastern boundary touches China (Tibet Autonomous Region). It shares borders with Kedarnath Wildlife Sanctuary and Govind National Park.

32. The Multi-Hazard Early Warning Decision Support System (MH-EWDSS) has been developed by which organization?

- [A] Indian Space Research Organisation
- [B] National Disaster Management Authority
- [C] India Meteorological Department



[D] Defence Research and Development Organisation

Answer: India Meteorological Department

The Multi-Hazard Early Warning Decision Support System (MH-EWDSS) marks a major advancement in India's disaster risk reduction and weather forecasting framework. It is developed by the India Meteorological Department (IMD) using open-source technology and in-house expertise. It is part of Mission Mausam, a digital transformation initiative, and was launched in 2024. It uses Geographic Information System (GIS) maps for real-time data collection, analysis, and dissemination.

33. What is the name of the campaign launched by the Madhya Pradesh government in April 2026 to promote school enrollment?

[A] Padhe Bharat Badhe Bharat Abhiyan

[B] School Chalen Hum Campaign

[C] Shiksha Sudhar Abhiyan

[D] Sarva Shiksha Enrollment Drive

Answer: School Chalen Hum Campaign

The 'School Chalen Hum' campaign was launched in Bhopal by Mohan Yadav to boost universal school enrolment and quality education. It was conducted from April 1-4, it targets all children across 55 districts and more than 50,000 villages. It aligns with Pravesh Utsav (admission festival) and focuses on distribution of 5.6 crore textbooks and learning materials. The initiative supports goals of the National Education Policy 2020 (NEP 2020). Enrolment increased by 19.6%, with 32.4% rise in government schools. Sandipani Vidyalayas and PM-SHRI (Prime Minister Schools for Rising India) schools promote quality infrastructure.

34. The Naval Science and Technological Laboratory functions under which organization?

[A] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited

[B] Defence Research and Development Organisation

[C] Ministry of Shipping

[D] Indian Navy

Answer: Defence Research and Development Organisation

Rajnath Singh laid the foundation of the Large Cavitation Tunnel (LCT) at Naval Science and Technological Laboratory (NSTL) in Visakhapatnam. NSTL is a premier lab under the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO). The Large Cavitation Tunnel (LCT) is a strategic facility for advanced hydrodynamic research and testing of naval systems. It will enable indigenous design, development, and testing of ships, submarines, and propulsion systems. It supports stealth, noise reduction, and next-generation underwater technologies. The facility allows both closed-loop (submarine) and free-surface (surface ship) simulations.

35. Min Aung Hlaing has been elected as president of which country?

[A] Myanmar

[B] Bangladesh

[C] Sri Lanka



[D] Indonesia

Answer: Myanmar

Min Aung Hlaing was elected President of Myanmar, consolidating his political power five years after the Myanmar coup 2021. His rise follows a controversial election dominated by the Union Solidarity and Development Party, widely criticised as a sham by Western nations. He overthrew the elected government of Aung San Suu Kyi in 2021, triggering protests that escalated into a nationwide civil war. He secured victory with 429 votes against rival Nyo Saw, backed by military-appointed lawmakers. His presidency is seen as an attempt to legitimise military rule under a civilian façade.

36. International Mine Awareness Day is observed every year on which day?

[A] April 3

[B] April 4

[C] April 5

[D] April 6

Answer: April 4

International Mine Awareness Day is observed every year on April 4 to raise awareness about the dangers of landmines and promote demining efforts. The 2026 theme is "Invest in Peace; Invest in Mine Action". This theme highlights the critical need for funding to accelerate mine clearance, support victims, and secure stability in conflict-affected areas. First observed in 2006, the day emphasizes global efforts in mine clearance, victim support, and the use of new technologies to create a landmine-free world.

37. Qdenga vaccine, recently approved in India, is used for prevention of which disease?

[A] Dengue

[B] Zika

[C] Malaria

[D] Typhoid

Answer: Dengue

The Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) has approved Qdenga for individuals aged 4–60 years, making it India's first dengue vaccine. Qdenga is a live-attenuated, tetravalent vaccine developed by Takeda Pharmaceutical, Japan. It targets all four dengue virus serotypes (DENV-1 to DENV-4), with strongest efficacy against DENV-2 and relatively lower against DENV-3 and DENV-4. It does not require pre-vaccination screening and is administered in two doses, spaced three months apart. The vaccine provides strong protection against severe dengue and reduces hospitalisation rates.

38. Scientists from which institute discovered a new gene regulation mechanism in Tuberculosis bacterium (*Mycobacterium tuberculosis*)?

[A] IIT Delhi

[B] AIIMS Delhi

[C] Bose Institute

[D] IISc Bengaluru

Answer: Bose Institute



Scientists at the Bose Institute discovered a new gene regulation mechanism in Tuberculosis bacterium (*Mycobacterium tuberculosis*). Transcription is the process where DNA is copied into RNA by RNA Polymerase (RNAP) for protein synthesis. Earlier, bacteria were believed to follow the Sigma Cycle, where sigma factor binds RNAP to initiate transcription and then detaches. The study found that in TB bacteria, the sigma factor (σ F) remains continuously attached to RNAP throughout transcription. This continuous binding helps activate survival genes, enabling bacteria to persist in hostile conditions inside the human body.

39. Capacity Building Commission (CBC) is associated with which programme?

- [A] Digital India
- [B] Skill India
- [C] Mission Karmayogi
- [D] Startup India

Answer: Mission Karmayogi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi addressed the Karmayogi Sadhana Saptah on the foundation day of the Capacity Building Commission (CBC). The Capacity Building Commission (CBC) was established in 2021 as the executive body and custodian of Mission Karmayogi. It functions as an autonomous body under the Prime Minister's Public Human Resources Council (PMHRC). The objective is to transform civil services from a rules-based system to a roles-based administration, improving efficiency and accountability.

40. The Indian softshell turtle is a freshwater turtle species native to which region?

- [A] South Asia
- [B] South Africa
- [C] Australia
- [D] Europe

Answer: South Asia

Police rescued 16 Indian Softshell turtles from illegal wildlife trade in Jharcha, Greater Noida, highlighting ongoing trafficking concerns. The Indian softshell turtle is a freshwater turtle species native to South Asia. They are found in rivers, canals, ponds, and freshwater systems. They are distributed across major river basins like Indus, Ganga, and Mahanadi. They occur in multiple Indian states (e.g., Assam, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha, West Bengal) and also in Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, and Pakistan.

41. Juang tribe is primarily found in which state?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Jharkhand
- [D] Bihar

Answer: Odisha

A 16-year-old girl from the Juang tribe in Odisha brought significant social change by transforming village attitudes toward child health and child marriage. The Juang tribe is one of the 13 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) among the 62 tribes found in



Odisha and is mainly concentrated in Keonjhar and Dhenkanal districts. They speak the Juang language, which belongs to the Munda branch of the Austroasiatic language family, and follow a structured clan and kinship system. Traditionally dependent on hunting, gathering, and limited cultivation, they later adapted to basket-weaving and barter trade after forest restrictions during the colonial period.

42. INS Aridhaman, that was recently seen in news, is part of which class of submarines?

- [A] Kalvari class
- [B] Scorpene class
- [C] Chakra class
- [D] Arihant class

Answer: Arihant class

India has inducted its third nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine, INS Aridhaman, into the Indian Navy, strengthening its strategic deterrence capability. INS Aridhaman is the third indigenously built Submersible Ship Ballistic Nuclear (SSBN) and the second submarine of the Arihant class (Submersible Ship Ballistic Nuclear). It has been developed under the Advanced Technology Vessel project (ATV) at the Ship Building Centre in Visakhapatnam. The submarine has a displacement of about 6,000 tonnes on the surface and 7,000 tonnes when submerged.

43. Which is the nodal ministry for the Jiyo Parsi Scheme?

- [A] Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- [B] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [C] Ministry of Minority Affairs
- [D] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Answer: Ministry of Minority Affairs

The Universal Parsi Registration Drive facilitation camp, organised by the Ministry of Minority Affairs, led to around 300 new registrations on the Jiyo Parsi Scheme portal. The Jiyo Parsi Scheme is a Central Sector Scheme launched in 2013-14 to address the declining population of the Parsi community in India. The scheme aims to stabilize and increase the Parsi population through scientific, medical, and social interventions. The Ministry of Minority Affairs serves as the nodal ministry for the scheme.

44. Barnawapara Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

- [A] Chhattisgarh
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Bihar
- [D] Jharkhand

Answer: Chhattisgarh

Blackbuck have been reintroduced into their natural habitat at Rampur grassland in Barnawapara Wildlife Sanctuary, supporting conservation efforts. The sanctuary is located in the northern part of Mahasamund district in Chhattisgarh. It derives its name from the Bar and Nawapara forest villages situated within its core area. The sanctuary's water sources are mainly tributaries of the Mahanadi River. The Balamdehi River forms its



western boundary, while the Jonk River forms its northeastern boundary.

45. What is the name of scheme launched by government to promote coal and lignite gasification projects in both public and private sectors?

- [A] Atmanirbhar Urja Abhiyan
- [B] Coal Gasification Incentive Scheme
- [C] National Biofuel Policy
- [D] National Biofuel Policy

Answer: Coal Gasification Incentive Scheme

The Union Government unveiled a roadmap to reduce dependence on imported petroleum, ammonia, and fertilizers, highlighting the Coal Gasification Incentive Scheme. The scheme was approved in 2024 to promote coal and lignite gasification projects in both public and private sectors. It aims to achieve 100 million tonnes of coal gasification by 2030, utilizing India's abundant coal reserves for sustainable industrial development. The scheme encourages participation of PSUs and private players to set up gasification projects across the country. It forms a key part of India's clean coal transition strategy.

46. National Maritime Day is observed annually on which day?

- [A] April 3
- [B] April 4
- [C] April 5
- [D] April 6

Answer: April 5

National Maritime Day is observed annually on April 5 to recognise India's maritime heritage and the role of the shipping sector in global trade and economic growth. The date commemorates the historic 1919 maiden voyage of SS Loyalty from Mumbai to London, marking India's entry into international shipping during colonial rule. The ship was operated by the Scindia Steam Navigation Company, one of India's earliest shipping enterprises. The day highlights the importance of the maritime sector, with over 90% of India's trade by volume carried through sea routes.

47. Rassie van der Dussen, who has announced his retirement from international cricket, belongs to which country?

- [A] England
- [B] Australia
- [C] South Africa
- [D] New Zealand

Answer: South Africa

South African player Rassie van der Dussen has announced his retirement from international cricket at the age of 35, ending a successful career as a dependable white-ball batter for South Africa national cricket team. He debuted late at 29 in a T20I against Zimbabwe and went on to play 18 Tests, 71 ODIs, and 57 T20Is. His strongest format was ODIs, where he scored 2657 runs at an average above 50, making him second only to AB de Villiers among South Africans. He was a key player during the 2019 Cricket World Cup



and became a regular middle-order batter.

48. Where was BIRAC-BioNEST Incubation Centre launched in April 2026?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Tamil Nadu
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Karnataka

Dr. Jitendra Singh, Minister of State (Independent Charge), Ministry of Science and Technology launched the BIRAC-BioNEST Incubation Centre at CSIR-Central Food Technological Research Institute in Mysuru, Karnataka. The centre is an initiative of Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council under the Ministry of Science and Technology. It aims to nurture entrepreneurship in food bioprocessing and biotechnology. The facility will help startups transform innovative ideas into commercially viable technologies. It offers infrastructure, mentorship, and funding support to early-stage biotech startups.

49. Which neighbouring country of India launched an emergency vaccination campaign targeting due to a fast-spreading measles outbreak in April 2026?

- [A] Bhutan
- [B] Nepal
- [C] Bangladesh
- [D] Myanmar

Answer: Bangladesh

Bangladesh launched an emergency vaccination campaign targeting over one million children due to a fast-spreading measles outbreak. Measles is a highly contagious airborne viral disease caused by a virus from the paramyxovirus family. It spreads through coughing, sneezing, or contact with infected respiratory secretions, and the virus can remain active in the air or on surfaces for up to two hours. The infection begins in the respiratory tract and spreads throughout the body, potentially causing severe complications and death.

50. The ECINet platform has been developed by which organization?

- [A] Ministry of Electronics and IT
- [B] Election Commission of India
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] National Informatics Centre

Answer: Election Commission of India

Recently, the Election Commission of India urged voters to use the “Know Your Candidates” (KYC) module on the ECINet platform to make informed electoral choices. ECINet is a single-point digital platform developed by Election Commission of India (ECI) for voters, election officials, political parties, and civil society. It integrates over 40 existing ECI apps, including Voter Helpline App, cVIGIL, Suvidha 2.0, Saksham, and others. The platform offers a user-friendly interface (UI/UX) with all electoral services in one place.



51. The Digital Life Certificate Campaign is conducted by which institution?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] NITI Aayog
- [C] Department of Pensions and Pensioners' Welfare
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Department of Pensions and Pensioners' Welfare

The Department of Pensions and Pensioners' Welfare has been conducting Digital Life Certificate (DLC) Campaigns since November 2022 to promote digital submission of life certificates and improve ease of living for pensioners. DLC Campaign 4.0 (Nov 1–30, 2025) was launched in New Delhi and became the largest-ever pensioners' welfare campaign in India. The campaign followed a saturation approach, organizing 75,000 camps across 2,000 cities/districts, supported by 1,400 nodal officers and 1.8 lakh postmen/Dak Sevaks for doorstep services.

52. Which state government launched the 'Safe Mobility Program' to promote women's empowerment and employment through Self-Help Groups?

- [A] Uttar Pradesh
- [B] Bihar
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

The Uttar Pradesh State Rural Livelihoods Mission launched the 'Safe Mobility Program' to promote women's empowerment and employment through SHGs. The initiative trains women as e-rickshaw drivers, ensuring safe, accessible, and dignified transport for women and girls. Around 1,000 e-rickshaws are being provided initially to women from Self-Help Groups. The programme has been launched in districts like Ayodhya, Gorakhpur, Varanasi, Kaushambi, and Jhansi, and will expand to cities like Lucknow and Prayagraj. It is implemented with technical support from Development Alternatives.

53. Who has been named the International Event Ambassador for World 10K Bengaluru 2026, World Athletics Gold Label Race?

- [A] Allyson Felix
- [B] Shelly-Ann Fraser-Pryce
- [C] Yelena Isinbayeva
- [D] Blanka Vlasic

Answer: Blanka Vlasic

Blanka Vlašić has been appointed International Event Ambassador for the World 10K Bengaluru 2026, scheduled on April 26. The event is a World Athletics Gold Label Race, attracting elite runners and mass participation. Blanka Vlašić is a double Olympic medallist (silver at Beijing 2008 Olympics and bronze at Rio 2016 Olympics) and a two-time World Champion in high jump. She holds a personal best of 2.08 m (2009), which is the Croatian national record and among the highest jumps in women's history.

54. Which state government has launched a special campaign to create a Farmer Registry to



ensure transparent delivery of benefits under agricultural schemes?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Himachal Pradesh
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Uttar Pradesh

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

The Uttar Pradesh government has launched a special campaign to create a Farmer Registry to ensure transparent delivery of benefits under agricultural schemes. The drive is being conducted through camps at Gram Sachivalayas across the state and will continue till mid-April. It aims to build an accurate digital database of farmers, helping in efficient implementation of schemes like PM Kisan Samman Nidhi Yojana. So far, over 1.72 crore farmers have been linked, but efforts are underway to include those still left out.

55. Recently, a rare Indian giant flying squirrel was spotted in which tiger reserve of Chhattisgarh?

- [A] Guru Ghasidas-Tamor Pingla Tiger Reserve
- [B] Achanakmar Tiger Reserve
- [C] Indravati Tiger Reserve
- [D] Udanti-Sitanadi Tiger Reserve

Answer: Udanti-Sitanadi Tiger Reserve

Recently, a rare Indian giant flying squirrel was spotted in Udanti-Sitanadi Tiger Reserve, indicating rich biodiversity and possible range extension. The reserve is located in Chhattisgarh and was formed by combining the Udanti and Sitanadi Wildlife Sanctuaries. Its river system is dominated by the Mahanadi River, along with tributaries like Udanti, Sitanadi, Indravati, and Pairi. It forms a critical forest corridor connecting to Indravati Tiger Reserve, aiding wildlife movement.

56. A Pentagon AI program called Project Maven was launched by which country?

- [A] United States
- [B] Iran
- [C] India
- [D] Australia

Answer: United States

The Pentagon's Project Maven AI program was launched by the United States in 2017. The program was launched by the United States in 2017. It uses machine learning and computer vision to automatically detect objects, movements, and patterns, reducing the need for manual analysis. The programme helps in real-time identification and tracking of targets, improving the speed and accuracy of military operations.

57. What is IUCN conservation status of Bengal Florican that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Critically Endangered



The Bengal Florican population is rapidly declining due to habitat loss caused by land conversion, agricultural expansion, burning, and fragmentation of grasslands. The Bengal Florican is a medium-sized bustard and an important grassland indicator species, often called the “dancer of the grasslands.” In India, it is found in areas such as Dudhwa National Park, Manas National Park, Kaziranga National Park, Orang National Park, and Dibru-Saikhowa National Park, along with parts of Arunachal Pradesh, Nepal, and Bangladesh. The species is classified as Critically Endangered, highlighting its high risk of extinction.

58. The India-UN Development Partnership Fund was established in which year?

- [A] 2017
- [B] 2018
- [C] 2019
- [D] 2020

Answer: 2017

The India-UN Development Partnership Fund Board of Directors recently met at India’s Permanent Mission in New York to review its operations, ongoing projects, and future plans. The fund was established in 2017 by India in partnership with the United Nations to support development projects in other developing countries, especially in the Global South. It is implemented by UN agencies in collaboration with partner governments and managed by the United Nations Office for South-South Cooperation. The fund promotes South-South Cooperation through demand-driven, country-led development initiatives aimed at shared prosperity.

59. Which state government has passed the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill 2026, becoming the second state after Uttarakhand to implement a UCC?

- [A] Rajasthan
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Madhya Pradesh

Answer: Gujarat

The Gujarat Legislative Assembly has passed the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill, 2026, becoming the second state after Uttarakhand to implement a UCC. The law introduces a uniform civil framework replacing religion-based personal laws in matters such as marriage, divorce, and inheritance. It ensures gender equality by granting equal inheritance rights to sons and daughters across all communities. The code mandates that marriages must be registered within 60 days, while live-in relationships must be registered within 30 days. It enforces strict monogamy by prohibiting polygamy and bigamy for all citizens irrespective of religion.

60. Which port was the top performer in cargo handling among major ports in FY 2025-26?

- [A] Deendayal Port (Gujarat)
- [B] Paradip Port (Odisha)
- [C] Mumbai Port



[D] Jawaharlal Nehru Port (Maharashtra)

Answer: Deendayal Port (Gujarat)

India's major ports handled a record 915.17 million tonnes (MT) of cargo in FY 2025-26, surpassing the 904 MT target and registering a 7.06% year-on-year growth. Among the top performers, Deendayal Port handled the highest cargo, followed by Paradip Port and Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority. Mormugao Port recorded the highest growth rate of 15.91% among major ports. Operational efficiency improved, with average vessel turnaround time reducing to 48.86 hours, while Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority led the container segment with 23.82 hours turnaround time.

61. India's first dedicated programme on administrative capacity building for scientists was launched under which mission?

[A] Digital India Mission

[B] Startup India Mission

[C] Skill India Mission

[D] Mission Karmayogi

Answer: Mission Karmayogi

Government launched the India's first dedicated programme on "Administrative Capacity Building for Scientists and Academicians" under Mission Karmayogi in April 2026. The launch took place during the SADHANA (Strengthening Adaptive Development and Humane Aptitude for National Advancement) Saptah at Vigyan Bhawan. The programme aims to equip scientists and academic leaders with governance, administrative, and decision-making skills.

62. What are "Corononema dhriti and Epacanthion indica" that were recently seen in news?

[A] Newly discovered species of marine nematodes

[B] Rare medicinal plants

[C] Invasive weeds

[D] Newly discovered species of spider

Answer: Newly discovered species of marine nematodes

Researchers from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) have discovered two new species of free-living marine nematodes off the coast of Tamil Nadu named Corononema dhriti and Epacanthion indica. Corononema dhriti is the fourth known species of its genus, previously recorded only in Australia, Thailand, and Vietnam. Epacanthion indica is a microscopic predator with specialized mandibles and teeth, feeding within the benthic food web. Marine nematodes play a key role in nutrient cycling, sediment health, and act as bio-indicators for environmental and climate change.

63. Madras Hedgehog, that was recently seen in news, is primarily found in which region of India?

[A] Northern Plains and Himalayas

[B] Peninsular India

[C] Western Ghats only

[D] None of the Above

Answer: Peninsular India



The complete mitochondrial genome of the Madras Hedgehog (*Paraechinus nudiventris*) has been analysed for the first time, revealing insights into its evolutionary history. Locally called Mulleli, it is also known as the bare-bellied hedgehog, discovered in 1851. They are found in dry scrublands, thorn forests, grasslands, and farmland edges in peninsular India—mainly Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, and parts of Karnataka. It is listed as Least Concern in International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) list.

64. To Lam has been elected as president of which country?

- [A] Vietnam
- [B] Indonesia
- [C] Singapore
- [D] Maldives

Answer: Vietnam

To Lam was unanimously elected President of Vietnam for a five-year term, while continuing as Communist Party chief. This consolidates power, departing from Vietnam's tradition of collective leadership and resembling Xi Jinping-style centralisation. He prioritised peace, stability, and economic growth with improved livelihoods. His rise follows an anti-corruption drive as head of the Ministry of Public Security.

65. Who became the world's first limbless (quadruple amputee) archery champion?

- [A] Payal Nag
- [B] Sheetal Devi
- [C] Jyothi Gupta
- [D] Khusi kumari

Answer: Payal Nag

Payal Nag, an 18-year-old from Odisha, became the world's first limbless (quadruple amputee) archery champion. She lost all four limbs in an electrocution accident at age eight but rebuilt her life through determination. She developed a unique technique using a custom prosthetic arm, shoulder, and mouth to shoot arrows. She won gold at the World Para Archery Series Final 2026 in Bangkok, defeating Sheetal Devi. Her achievement symbolizes resilience, innovation, and excellence in para sports.

66. The Piprahwa Stupa is widely identified with which ancient city?

- [A] Kushinagar
- [B] Vaishali
- [C] Kapilavastu
- [D] Sarnath

Answer: Kapilavastu

Piprahwa Relics will arrive in Leh on Buddha Purnima; repatriated from Hong Kong in July 2025. It was discovered in 1898 by William Claxton Peppé at Piprahwa, Uttar Pradesh. It was excavated from Piprahwa Stupa, linked to ancient Kapilavastu, associated with Lord Buddha. Relics include bone fragments, caskets, sandstone coffer, gold ornaments, and gemstones. Brahmi inscription confirms association with Buddha by Sakya clan. Ladakh served as a gateway for Buddhist cultural diffusion across Asia.



67. Which city has been declared the sole capital of Andhra Pradesh under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation (Amendment) Act, 2026?

- [A] Amaravati
- [B] Visakhapatnam
- [C] Vijaywada
- [D] Kurnool

Answer: Amaravati

The Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation (Amendment) Act 2026 was notified after receiving assent from Droupadi Murmu, officially declaring Amaravati as the sole capital of Andhra Pradesh. The amendment modifies the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act 2014 by explicitly stating that Amaravati shall be the capital. After bifurcation and creation of Telangana, Hyderabad was designated as a common capital for up to 10 years, after which Andhra Pradesh had to establish its own capital. The Andhra Pradesh Assembly passed a resolution on March 28 supporting Amaravati as the sole capital, enabling the legislative process.

68. Umred Pauni Karhandla Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Tamil Nadu

Answer: Maharashtra

A rare melanistic (black-coloured) spotted deer (chital) was recently sighted at the Umred Pauni Karhandla Wildlife Sanctuary near Nagpur. The sanctuary is located across Pauni tehsil in Bhandara district and Umred, Kuhi, and Bhivapur talukas of Nagpur district in Maharashtra. It is bounded along the northeast by the Wainganga River and the Gose Khurd Dam. The forest corridor along the Wainganga River connects this sanctuary with the Tadoba Andhari Tiger Reserve, aiding wildlife movement and ecological connectivity.

69. What is the theme of Poshan Pakhwada 2026?

- [A] Nutrition for All
- [B] Healthy India, Strong India
- [C] Maximizing Brain Development in the First Six Years of Life
- [D] Malnutrition-Free India

Answer: Maximizing Brain Development in the First Six Years of Life

The Ministry of Women and Child Development celebrated the 8th edition of Poshan Pakhwada from 9th to 23rd April 2026. It is a 15-day nationwide campaign held annually in March/April to promote nutrition awareness and healthy eating through Jan Andolan and Jan Bhagidari. The theme for 2026 is "Maximizing Brain Development in the First Six Years of Life." It promotes play-based education (3–6 years) to support holistic development and school readiness. The campaign highlights the role of parents and communities in reducing children's screen time and encouraging active engagement.

70. Where was the International Conference on "Spacecraft Mission Operations: SMOPS- 2026"



held?

- [A] Chennai
- [B] Indore
- [C] Bangalore
- [D] New Delhi

Answer: Bangalore

The 2nd edition of International Conference on Spacecraft Mission Operations SMOPS 2026 is held from 8–10 April 2026 in Bangalore with the theme “Innovative Operations for Smart and Sustainable Space Mission Management – Next Generation.” It is jointly organised by Indian Space Research Organisation, Astronautical Society of India, and International Academy of Astronautics. The conference focuses on mission operations, advanced mission design, automation, large constellations, human spaceflight, robotics, AI, cybersecurity, space policy, and interplanetary exploration. It also addresses future-oriented topics in both upstream and downstream space sectors and evolving ground station operations.

71. Exercise Cyclone - IV is conducted between India and which country?

- [A] France
- [B] Egypt
- [C] Australia
- [D] Maldives

Answer: Egypt

The 4th edition of Exercise Cyclone IV between India and Egypt is scheduled to be held from 9 to 17 April 2026 at Anshas, Egypt. The exercise reflects growing defence cooperation between India and Egypt and follows the previous successful edition held in India. The Indian contingent consists of 25 personnel from Special Forces units, training alongside Egyptian Special Forces. The aim is to enhance joint mission planning and improve interoperability through exchange of best practices in special operations.

72. Skills Outcomes Fund initiative has been launched under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Education
- [B] Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
- [C] Ministry of Finance
- [D] Ministry of Labour and Employment

Answer: Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Skill Development and Entrepreneurship and Minister of State for Education Shri Jayant Chaudhary has launched a ₹530 crore 'Skills Outcomes Fund' campaign, anchored by the National Skill Development Corporation under the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship. The fund aims to mobilise public and private capital to scale outcomes-based financing (OBF), linking investments directly to verified employment outcomes such as job placement, retention, and career progression. It promotes a blended finance model combining government funding with private sector investments and focuses on demand-driven, employer-led skilling.



73. Which institution launched the report titled “From Borrowers to Builders: Women and India’s Evolving Credit Market”?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India
- [B] Ministry of Finance
- [C] Securities Exchange Board of India
- [D] NITI Aayog

Answer: NITI Aayog

NITI Aayog released the 2nd edition of the report “From Borrowers to Builders: Women and India’s Evolving Credit Market” on 7 April 2026 in New Delhi. The report highlights that women borrowers in India hold a credit portfolio of ₹76 lakh crore, accounting for 26% of total system credit. Women’s credit exposure has grown 4.8 times since 2017, indicating a shift from basic access to deeper participation in the formal credit ecosystem. The number of credit-active women borrowers has grown at a CAGR of 9% (2017–2025), while credit penetration increased from 19% to 36%. Total outstanding credit to women rose from ₹16 lakh crore in 2017 to ₹76 lakh crore in 2025.

74. Mount Semeru, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Singapore
- [B] Japan
- [C] Malaysia
- [D] Indonesia

Answer: Indonesia

Mount Semeru, the tallest and one of the most active volcanoes in Indonesia, recently erupted multiple times, sending ash plumes up to 1,100 metres high. Also known as Mahameru (“The Great Mountain”), it is an active stratovolcano (composite volcano) with a steep profile and frequent explosive eruptions. It is the highest peak on the island of Java and holds cultural and religious significance locally. It is located in East Java as part of the Tengger Massif, which also includes Mount Bromo.

75. Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana was launched under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Ministry of MSME
- [C] Ministry of Commerce
- [D] Ministry of Law and Justice

Answer: Ministry of Finance

Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana completed 11 years since its launch in April 2015, aiming to promote financial inclusion for unfunded micro-enterprises. It is a Central Sector Scheme under the Ministry of Finance providing collateral-free credit to micro and small enterprises. The scheme targets non-corporate, non-farm income-generating activities across manufacturing, trading, services, and allied agriculture sectors. Loans are categorised into four tiers based on the stage of business growth and funding requirements.

76. Mohra Power Project, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state/UT?



- [A] Jammu and Kashmir
- [B] Uttarakhand
- [C] Delhi
- [D] Himachal Pradesh

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

The Jammu and Kashmir government is reviving the historic Mohra Power Project to boost hydropower development amid the Indus Waters Treaty remaining in abeyance. The Mohra (Mahura) Power Project is located on the Jhelum River in Uri, Baramulla district, Jammu and Kashmir. It was commissioned in 1905 and is regarded as the first hydroelectric power plant in the Kashmir Valley. The project was originally designed as a run-of-the-river hydropower plant with a capacity of about 5 MW. It is now being upgraded to a capacity of 10.5 MW to enhance power generation.

77. Where was Yoga Mahotsav-2026 held?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Bihar

Answer: Maharashtra

The Ministry of AYUSH launched the 75-day countdown to International Day of Yoga 2026 with Yoga Mahotsav-2026 in Lonar, Maharashtra. The event was organised by the Morarji Desai National Institute of Yoga at Chhatrapati Shri Shivaji Maharaj Udyan in Buldhana district. Around 5,000 participants performed Trikonasana together, creating a record in the Asia Book of Records for the largest gathering performing the pose. The mass performance symbolised collective participation and a global movement towards holistic health and harmony.

78. The Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) platforms are regulated by which authority?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India
- [B] Ministry of Finance
- [C] Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
- [D] National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

Answer: Reserve Bank of India

Reserve Bank of India proposed removing due diligence for onboarding Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) on Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) platforms to enhance ease of doing business. Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) is an electronic platform enabling financing/discounting of MSME trade receivables via multiple financiers. The platforms are regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Its objective is to ensure quicker payments and improved working capital for MSMEs.

79. The headquarters of Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) is located in which city?

- [A] Mumbai
- [B] New Delhi



[C] Chennai

[D] Hyderabad

Answer: New Delhi

Indian Council of Agricultural Research set up a Special Task Force (STF) to design mitigation strategies for agriculture sector challenges. Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) is an autonomous body under Department of Agricultural Research and Education (DARE), Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare. It was established on 16 July 1929 under Societies Registration Act, 1860, based on Royal Commission on Agriculture recommendations. ICAR played a key role in Green Revolution and advancing agricultural higher education; headquarters at New Delhi.

80. The National Quantum Mission (NQM) was launched by which organization?

[A] Department of Science and Technology

[B] Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR)

[C] Indian Space Research Organisation

[D] Ministry of Electronics and IT

Answer: Department of Science and Technology

India has successfully demonstrated a 1,000-kilometre quantum communication network under the National Quantum Mission, a major breakthrough in secure communication technologies. The National Quantum Mission (NQM) was launched by the Department of Science & Technology with an outlay of Rs.6003 crore for 2023-24 to 2030-31. Its objective is to seed, nurture, and scale up scientific and industrial research and development (R&D) and create an innovative ecosystem in Quantum Technology (QT). It is one of nine initiatives under the Prime Minister's Science Technology Innovation Advisory Council (PM-STIAC).

81. Which state is the leading producer of Makhana, also called Fox Nuts?

[A] Odisha

[B] Haryana

[C] Jharkhand

[D] Bihar

Answer: Bihar

Exports of Makhana, also known as Fox Nuts, have declined due to reduced demand and prices caused by the ongoing West Asia war. Makhana is the dried edible seed of the prickly water lily or gorgon plant (*Euryale ferox*) and is nicknamed the "Black Diamond" because of its dark outer layer. The plant is native to South-East Asia and China but is now cultivated worldwide. In India, it is mainly produced in Bihar, West Bengal, Manipur, Tripura, Assam, Jammu & Kashmir, Odisha, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, and Uttar Pradesh, with Bihar as the leading producer. Makhana is included under the Union government's One District One Product (ODOP) scheme.

82. Which city has launched India's first AI-powered 'Breathable Buildings' initiative?

[A] Hyderabad

[B] Chennai



[C] Mumbai

[D] New Delhi

Answer: Mumbai

Mumbai has launched India's first AI-powered "breathable buildings" pilot, focusing on indoor air quality as a core infrastructure feature. Developer Superb Realty has partnered with deep-tech firm Praan to deploy the system across a 1 million sq ft commercial project, with plans to expand to residential and mixed-use developments. Praan's system uses real-time environmental sensing and AI-driven optimisation to dynamically manage indoor and outdoor air conditions. The initiative represents a shift from "smart homes" to "healthy buildings," where air quality may become a key real estate differentiator.

83. Who has been selected for the UT-ORNL Governor's Chair for Quantum Devices in the United States?

[A] Deep Jariwala

[B] Arvind Krishna

[C] Raghunath Mashelkar

[D] Ajay Kumar Sood

Answer: Deep Jariwala

Deep Jariwala has been selected for the UT-ORNL Governor's Chair for Quantum Devices in the United States. The position is jointly managed by University of Tennessee and Oak Ridge National Laboratory, combining academic teaching with high-end research. The Governor's Chair programme aims to attract top global scientists, promote innovation, and link academic research with real-world applications. Deep Jariwala, currently at University of Pennsylvania, is known for work in quantum materials, microelectronics, and next-generation computing, with more than 180 research papers and patents.

84. Which organization has launched a new artificial intelligence model, Muse Spark, under its Superintelligence Labs initiative?

[A] Microsoft

[B] Amazon

[C] Meta

[D] Google

Answer: Meta

Meta has launched a new artificial intelligence model, Muse Spark, under its Superintelligence Labs initiative. Muse Spark can perform tasks such as calorie estimation, object visualisation, and answering user queries. The model is currently available on Meta AI chatbot and will be expanded to WhatsApp, Instagram, and Facebook. Meta has acknowledged the feedback and plans to improve future versions of the model.

85. Which village has been declared a 'profanity-free village' in Madhya Pradesh?

[A] Mandla

[B] Damoh

[C] Bhind

[D] Borsar

**Answer: Borsar**

Borsar Village in Madhya Pradesh has emerged as a profanity-free village promoting respectful communication among residents. Villagers have collectively pledged to avoid abusive language in daily interactions. Awareness campaigns have been conducted to encourage discipline and positive behaviour across the community. The initiative is followed by people of all age groups, ensuring widespread participation. It has led to improved social harmony and a noticeable reduction in conflicts within the village.

86. Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) is established under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Ministry of Electronics and IT
- [C] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [D] Ministry of Defence

Answer: Ministry of Home Affairs

Financial Intelligence Unit-India and Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to strengthen coordination against cyber frauds and financial crimes. Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) is the national agency for receiving, analysing, and disseminating information on suspicious financial transactions and combating money laundering and terror financing. Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) is established under the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) as the national nodal agency to fight cybercrime. It provides a framework and ecosystem for law enforcement agencies (LEAs) to handle cybercrimes in a coordinated and comprehensive way.

87. Indian Army recently launched which operation to evacuate tourists after landslide in North Sikkim?

- [A] Operation Sadbhavana
- [B] Operation Him Vijay
- [C] Operation Him Setu
- [D] Operation Rakshak

Answer: Operation Him Setu

Indian Army's Trishakti Corps launched Operation Him Setu to evacuate stranded tourists in Lachen, North Sikkim. The operation was necessitated due to a landslide disrupting connectivity between Lachen and Chungthang. Despite harsh weather and heavy snowfall, troops restored access by opening critical passes and activating alternate routes. Border Roads Organisation is coordinating with the Army for road clearance, snow removal, and connectivity restoration. Evacuation is being carried out in phases, with 135 tourists, 32 light vehicles, and 10 motorcycles safely evacuated so far.

88. The Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) is an autonomous body under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Culture
- [B] Ministry of External Affairs
- [C] Ministry of Tourism
- [D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Ministry of External Affairs



The Minister of State for External Affairs highlighted the role of the Indian Council for Cultural Relations in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy during a visit to Yangon, Myanmar. The Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) is an autonomous body under the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), Government of India. It was established in 1950 by Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, India's first Education Minister. ICCR promotes India's external cultural relations through cultural exchanges and a global network of cultural centres.

89. The WAVES OTT platform has been developed by which organization?

- [A] Doordarshan
- [B] Prasar Bharati
- [C] Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- [D] All India Radio

Answer: Prasar Bharati

The Publications Division has made its flagship journals Yojana and Kurukshetra available free on the WAVES OTT platform. WAVES (Wireless Access to Virtual Entertainment Services) is a digital streaming platform developed by Prasar Bharati. It aims to meet India's rising demand for Over-The-Top (OTT) streaming services. The platform provides live television, video-on-demand, games, radio streaming, and e-commerce integration via the Open Network for Digital Commerce.

90. Indravati Tiger Reserve is located in which state?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Andhra Pradesh
- [D] Chhattisgarh

Answer: Chhattisgarh

The Indravati Tiger Reserve in Chhattisgarh is reopening for tourism, marking a shift from conflict to conservation and eco-tourism. The reserve, along with Bhairamgarh and Pamed Wildlife Sanctuaries, forms the larger Indravati landscape. It has ecological connectivity with tiger reserves like Kawal Tiger Reserve, Tadoba-Andhari Tiger Reserve, and Kanha Tiger Reserve. The Indravati River forms its northern and western boundary and an interstate border with Maharashtra.

91. Vantara University, the world's first integrated global university for wildlife conservation, has been launched in which city?

- [A] Jamnagar
- [B] Surat
- [C] Vadodara
- [D] Junagadh

Answer: Jamnagar

Vantara University, the world's first integrated global university for wildlife conservation and veterinary sciences, has been launched in Jamnagar. It is an initiative of Anant Ambani, Executive Director of Reliance Industries and founder of Vantara. The university focuses on animal welfare, scientific research, and conservation-based education inspired



by Nalanda University ethos. The objective is to develop skilled professionals in veterinary medicine, wildlife conservation, and ecosystem health.

92. Exercise Brahmastra, a major live-firing exercise by the Indian Army, was held in which state?

- [A] Arunachal Pradesh
- [B] Punjab
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Rajasthan

Exercise Brahmastra, a major live-firing exercise by the Indian Army, was held at the Pokhran Field Firing Range in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan. The purpose of this exercise is to showcase the combat capabilities of the newly inducted AH-64E Apache attack helicopters and test coordination between air and ground forces. The Boeing AH-64 Apache is a multi-role attack helicopter equipped with a 30 mm chain gun, AGM-114 Hellfire missiles, and rockets for precision strikes. The exercise tested operational readiness, coordination between pilots and ground crews, and precision targeting in simulated battlefield conditions.

93. Which institution released the reports titled “Ease of Doing Research & Development in India”?

- [A] NITI Aayog
- [B] Department of Science and Technology
- [C] Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: NITI Aayog

NITI Aayog released two reports— “Ease of Doing Research & Development in India” and “Survey Report on Ease of Doing R&D in India” on 9 April 2026 in New Delhi. The reports are based on consultations with 400+ institutions and inputs from 850+ scientists and researchers across India. The objective is to improve India’s Research and Development (R&D) ecosystem by making it more efficient, innovation-driven, and facilitative. The reports emphasize private sector participation, flexible systems, and a trust-based environment to boost India’s global leadership in science and innovation.

94. Womaniya is a flagship initiative of which platform?

- [A] Government e-Marketplace (GeM)
- [B] Startup India
- [C] National Small Industries Corporation
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Government e-Marketplace (GeM)

More than 2 lakh women-led Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) on Government e-Marketplace under the Womaniya Initiative secured 13.7 lakh orders in FY 2025–26. The Womaniya Initiative was launched in 2019 by Government e-Marketplace (GeM). It promotes women entrepreneurs’ participation in government procurement through a dedicated digital interface. Government e-Marketplace is an online platform for end-to-end public procurement by Central and State governments, Public Sector Undertakings



(PSUs), Panchayats, and cooperatives.

95. Which state/UT deployed a humanoid robot named Nila for the first time during Assembly elections?

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Assam
- [D] Puducherry

Answer: Puducherry

Puducherry deployed a humanoid robot named Nila for the first time during Assembly elections at VOC Government School on 8 April 2026. Nila is an event-based interactive humanoid robot developed by Robo Mirror. The purpose is to create a high-tech, voter-friendly environment and attract young and first-time voters. It was dressed in a traditional saree, welcomed voters with flowers, and guided them inside the polling booth.

96. Which bank has become India's largest Urban Co-operative Bank (UCB) after crossing ₹1 lakh crore total business in FY 2025–26?

- [A] Cosmos Co-operative Bank
- [B] Abhyudaya Cooperative Bank
- [C] Shamrao Vithal Cooperative Bank
- [D] Saraswat Co-operative Bank

Answer: Saraswat Co-operative Bank

Saraswat Co-operative Bank Limited has become India's largest Urban Co-operative Bank (UCB) after crossing ₹1 lakh crore total business in FY 2025–26. This milestone highlights the bank's strong growth trajectory and leadership in the co-operative banking sector. The achievement is driven by an expanding customer base, improved services, and enhanced financial performance. It reflects the increasing importance of Urban Co-operative Banks (UCBs) in India's banking ecosystem. The development underscores growing trust and efficiency in cooperative banking institutions.

97. Shree Chamundeshwari Temple, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Tamil Nadu
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Karnataka

The Karnataka High Court criticized the State Government for violating judicial orders banning construction at Shree Chamundeshwari Temple. The temple is located atop Chamundi Hills in Karnataka and is a major religious site. It is dedicated to Goddess Chamundeshwari, an incarnation of Goddess Durga. The original structure dates back to the 12th century under the Hoysala rulers. It was later expanded during the Vijayanagara Empire in the 17th century Common Era (CE).

98. The PACE satellite mission has been launched by which space organization?

- [A] National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)



- [B] China National Space Administration (CNSA)
- [C] European Space Agency (ESA)
- [D] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

Answer: National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)

Recent research shows PACE Satellite can detect nitrogen dioxide (NO₂) pollution at very fine scales, identifying emissions from individual factories and highways. This is a major advancement in air quality monitoring and environmental governance. PACE (Plankton, Aerosol, Cloud, and Ocean Ecosystem) is a NASA satellite mission. It was launched in 2024 into a Sun-synchronous orbit for consistent global observation. It provides hyperspectral coverage of Earth every 1–2 days. It improves climate studies by offering finer wavelength resolution than earlier satellites.

99. Hib Disease, that was recently seen in news, is caused by which agent?

- [A] Bacteria
- [B] Virus
- [C] Fungus
- [D] Protozoa

Answer: Bacteria

Hib (Haemophilus influenzae type b) disease is resurging in the United States due to declining childhood vaccination rates. It is caused by the bacterium Haemophilus influenzae type b infection and mainly affects children under 5 years. It can cause mild infections (ear infections, bronchitis) and severe diseases like meningitis and bloodstream infections. Despite its name, it does not cause influenza (flu). Transmission occurs through respiratory droplets (coughing, sneezing) and close contact. Symptoms vary depending on the infected body part; severe cases may lead to death or long-term complications.

100. The Export Inspection Council functions under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Agriculture
- [B] Ministry of Finance
- [C] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [D] Ministry of External Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Commerce and Industry

India has limited the requirement of certification from the Export Inspection Council (EIC) for rice exports only to select countries—European Union (EU), United Kingdom (UK), Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway, and Switzerland. The Export Inspection Council was established under the Export (Quality Control and Inspection) Act, 1963. It ensures quality and safety of Indian export products to meet importing country standards. It functions as India's official export certification authority. The Council operates under the administrative control of the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, which is its nodal ministry.

101. The Lanjia Saora tribe is primarily found in which state?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Karnataka



[D] Kerala

Answer: Odisha

The Lanjia Saora Tribe is witnessing cultural reinterpretation as younger members balance tradition with modern influences. They are an ancient tribe of Odisha, classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG). They exhibit Proto-Australoid physical characteristics. They live in scattered mud-and-thatch houses in hilly terrains. They are known for their distinct art, including wall paintings (Idital), and rich musical traditions using instruments like gongs and cymbals.

102. Exercise DUSTLIK is a joint military exercise between India and which country?

[A] Australia

[B] Uzbekistan

[C] Russia

[D] Maldives

Answer: Uzbekistan

Exercise DUSTLIK 2026 has commenced in Namangan at the Gurumsaray Field Training Area from 12–25 April 2026. It is the 7th edition of the India–Uzbekistan joint military exercise, conducted annually on an alternating basis between the two countries. The previous edition (2025) was held at Aundh, Pune in India. It aims to enhance military cooperation and joint operational capabilities in semi-mountainous terrain.

103. Ayush Shetty won which medal at the Badminton Asia Championships 2026?

[A] Gold medal

[B] Silver medal

[C] Bronze medal

[D] None of the Above

Answer: Silver medal

Ayush Shetty won the silver medal at the Badminton Asia Championships 2026 held in Ningbo, China. He finished as runner-up, losing the final to Shi Yuqi with a score of 8–21, 10–21. Shi Yuqi secured the Men's Singles gold, marking China's first title in this category since 2017. Ayush Shetty created history by winning India's first Men's Singles silver in 61 years at the tournament. Earlier, he defeated defending champion Kunlavut Vitidsarn of Thailand in the semifinals.

104. Which wrestler became the first Indian after Bajrang Punia (2019) to win gold medal in the 65 kg category at the Asian Wrestling Championships 2026?

[A] Sujeet Kalkal

[B] Abhimanyou Mandwal

[C] Aman Sehrawat

[D] Mukul Dahiya

Answer: Sujeet Kalkal

At the Asian Wrestling Championships 2026 in Bishkek, India won two gold medals in men's freestyle wrestling. Sujeet Kalkal won gold in the 65 kg category, defeating Uzbekistan's Umidjon Jalolov 8–1, becoming the first Indian after Bajrang Punia (2019) to



win in this category. This marks Sujeet's third consecutive gold medal in 2026, highlighting his consistent performance. Abhimanyou Mandwal secured gold in the 70 kg category, defeating Mongolia's Olympian Tömör-Ochiryn Tulga 5–3.

105. In April 2026, which state has been declared Naxal-free after the surrender of 42 cadres of the Communist Party of India (Maoist)?

- [A] Chhattisgarh
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Jharkhand
- [D] Telangana

Answer: Telangana

Telangana has been declared Naxal-free after the surrender of 42 cadres of the Communist Party of India (Maoist). The announcement was made by Telangana Director General of Police (DGP) B. Shivadhar Reddy, stating that the Telangana State Committee has been dismantled. Among those who surrendered was PLGA (People's Liberation Guerrilla Army) commander Sodi Malla. Surrendered cadres handed over 36 firearms, including AK-47 rifles, Self-Loading Rifles (SLRs), grenades, and large quantities of ammunition. Additional recoveries include 1,007 live rounds of ammunition and 800 grams of gold.

106. Which company launched Project Glasswing to secure critical software infrastructure using advanced AI systems?

- [A] Google
- [B] Microsoft
- [C] Anthropic
- [D] OpenAI

Answer: Anthropic

Anthropic launched Project Glasswing to secure critical software infrastructure using advanced AI systems. The initiative involves a global coalition of major tech firms including Amazon Web Services, Apple, Google, Microsoft, and NVIDIA. It uses Claude Mythos Preview, an advanced AI model, to detect and fix software vulnerabilities across sectors like banking, healthcare, and telecom. The model has identified critical flaws in operating systems and browsers, including vulnerabilities undetected for years.

107. What is the current IUCN conservation status of 'Southern Elephant Seal'?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Vulnerable

The International Union for Conservation of Nature has reclassified the Southern Elephant Seal from Least Concern to Vulnerable on its Red List. It is the largest seal species and among the biggest mammals after whales. It is known as the deepest-diving seal, often diving 300–800 m for approx 30 minutes. It is found in circumpolar regions of the



Southern Ocean, including Antarctica and southern parts of Africa, South America, and Australia.

108. According to India Tech Annual Funding Report 2026, what is India's rank globally in startup funding?

- [A] First
- [B] Second
- [C] Third
- [D] Fourth

Answer: Fourth

Tracxn released the India Tech Annual Funding Report 2026, highlighting trends in India's startup ecosystem. India's tech startups raised USD 11.7 billion in FY26 (Financial Year 2025–26), showing an 18% decline from FY25 (USD 14.3B) but a 20% increase over FY24 (USD 9.7B). India ranked 4th globally, behind United States, United Kingdom, and China, but ahead of Germany and France.

109. What is the primary objective of the Sagarmala Programme?

- [A] Expansion of air transport
- [B] Port-led development
- [C] Agricultural modernization
- [D] Urban housing development

Answer: Port-led development

The Sagarmala Programme was launched in March 2015 to promote port-led development and enhance India's logistics efficiency and trade competitiveness. The programme currently includes 845 projects worth ₹6.06 lakh crore, out of which 315 projects worth ₹1.57 lakh crore have been completed. It aims to reduce transportation costs by promoting coastal shipping and inland waterways alongside existing road and rail networks. The programme is based on five pillars, namely port modernization and new port development, port connectivity enhancement, port-led industrialization, coastal community development, and promotion of coastal shipping and inland waterways transport.

110. In April 2026, Khanij Bidesh India Limited (KABIL) has received environmental clearance for lithium exploration in which country?

- [A] Australia
- [B] Chile
- [C] Argentina
- [D] Bolivia

Answer: Argentina

Khanij Bidesh India Limited (KABIL) has received environmental clearance from the Government of Argentina for deep exploration of five brine-based lithium blocks. This marks a significant step in securing critical minerals, especially lithium, which is essential for batteries and clean energy technologies. Khanij Bidesh India Limited (KABIL) is a joint venture of three Central Public Sector Enterprises—National Aluminium Company Limited



(NALCO), Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL), and Mineral Exploration and Consultancy Limited (MECL)—with a shareholding ratio of 40:30:30.

111. Which state has launched India's first quantum test facilities?

- [A] Andhra Pradesh
- [B] Tamil Nadu
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

Andhra Pradesh has launched India's first quantum test facilities under the Amaravati Quantum Valley initiative on the occasion of World Quantum Day (April 14). The facilities include two Quantum Reference Facilities at SRM University, Amaravati and Medha Towers, Gannavaram, creating India's first quantum test and certification ecosystem. The systems operate at extremely low temperatures (near -273°C) and support advanced quantum research and innovation. The initiative promotes collaboration among academia, startups, and industry, with support from institutions like Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR), Indian Institute of Science (IISc), and Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).

112. Who has been appointed as the next Director of the Israeli Institute for Intelligence and Special Operations, Mossad?

- [A] David Barnea
- [B] Roman Gofman
- [C] Yoav Gallant
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Roman Gofman

Benjamin Netanyahu has appointed Major General Roman Gofman as the next Director of Mossad (Israeli Institute for Intelligence and Special Operations). The appointment was approved by the advisory committee on senior appointments. Roman Gofman currently serves as the military secretary to the Prime Minister and has been praised for his resourcefulness and strategic thinking. He will assume office on July 2, 2026, for a tenure of five years. The appointment comes amid ongoing regional tensions, highlighting the importance of strengthening Israel's intelligence and security framework.

113. Which university won the Association of Indian Universities (AIU) National Moot Court Competition 2026?

- [A] Chandigarh University
- [B] Lucknow University
- [C] Banaras Hindu University
- [D] Lovely Professional University

Answer: Banaras Hindu University

Banaras Hindu University won the Association of Indian Universities (AIU) National Moot Court Competition 2026 held at Integral University, securing ₹25,000 along with trophies and medals. Chandigarh University finished as the runner-up and received ₹11,000.



Aligarh Muslim University received recognition for inspiring excellence, while Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University and University of Lucknow were recognised as best regional teams. The competition was held from April 9–11, 2026, with participation from 40 teams across India, promoting advocacy skills and legal understanding.

114. Which institution acts as the implementation agency of Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 scheme?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India
- [B] Small Industries Development Bank of India
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Small Industries Development Bank of India

Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 has been notified with a corpus of ₹10,000 crore to mobilize venture and growth capital for startups. It builds upon the earlier Fund of Funds for Startups (FFS 1.0) launched in 2016 under the Startup India Action Plan to address funding gaps. The fund will invest in SEBI-registered Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), which will further invest in eligible startups. Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) acts as the Implementation Agency. The scheme aims to boost innovation, job creation, manufacturing, and support India's vision of becoming a global innovation hub under Viksit Bharat 2047.

115. Which institution released a report titled "Exploring Safeguards in Digital Payments to Curb Frauds"?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Reserve Bank of India
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] National Payments Corporation of India

Answer: Reserve Bank of India

Reserve Bank of India has released a report titled "Exploring Safeguards in Digital Payments to Curb Frauds" to address rising digital payment scams. It proposes a cooling-off period of one hour for transfers above ₹10,000 to new beneficiaries, allowing users to cancel fraudulent transactions. A trusted person mechanism is suggested, where high-value transactions above ₹50,000 by senior citizens or persons with disabilities may require secondary approval. A kill switch facility is proposed to enable users to instantly disable all payment channels during emergencies. Whitelisting of beneficiaries would allow users to pre-approve trusted payees and avoid additional verification or delays.

116. Where was the 9th Indian Ocean Conference (IOC 2026) held?

- [A] Mauritius
- [B] Sri Lanka
- [C] Maldives
- [D] India

Answer: Mauritius

The Indian Ocean Conference 2026 was held from April 10–12, 2026, in Port Louis,



Mauritius. The theme of the conference was “Collective Stewardship for Indian Ocean Governance,” focusing on regional cooperation and maritime security. It was organised by India Foundation in association with the Ministry of External Affairs and the Government of Mauritius. The conference saw participation from delegates, ministers, and senior leaders from over 25 countries. India emphasised addressing chokepoint vulnerabilities, building trusted partnerships, and ensuring resilient and stable growth in the Indian Ocean region.

117. What is Keytruda, that was recently mentioned in news?

- [A] An immunotherapy drug
- [B] A type of virus
- [C] Rare medicinal plant
- [D] Newly discovered species of Fish

Answer: An immunotherapy drug

Keytruda is an immunotherapy drug (pembrolizumab) used globally to treat cancers such as lung, cervical, renal cell, and aggressive breast cancer. It is manufactured by Merck & Co. and belongs to a class of drugs called checkpoint inhibitors. It is a monoclonal antibody, meaning it is a laboratory-made molecule designed to target specific cancer-related proteins. It blocks PD-1 receptors on T-cells, preventing interaction with PD-L1 on cancer cells, thereby enabling the immune system to attack cancer cells. In India, it is available in tertiary care hospitals, while indigenous CAR-T therapy like NexCAR19 has also been developed for cancer treatment.

118. Nagarjunasagar–Srisailem Tiger Reserve (NSTR) is located in which state?

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] Andhra Pradesh
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

Nagarjunasagar–Srisailem Tiger Reserve (NSTR) is located in the Nallamala hill ranges of Andhra Pradesh and is one of the largest tiger reserves in India. It is named after the Nagarjuna Sagar Dam and Srisailem Dam situated in the region. The reserve comprises two wildlife sanctuaries: Rajiv Gandhi Wildlife Sanctuary and Gundla Brahmeswaram Wildlife Sanctuary. The Krishna River flows through the reserve, shaping its ecology and biodiversity. Recently, plans have been revived to establish a tiger enclosure to care for injured, abandoned, or orphaned tiger cubs.

119. World Quantum Day is celebrated every year on which day?

- [A] April 13
- [B] April 14
- [C] April 15
- [D] April 16

Answer: April 14

World Quantum Day is celebrated every year on 14th April to raise global awareness



about quantum science and technology. The day aims to foster a better understanding of quantum mechanics,, which powers technologies like lasers, MRI scanners, and modern computing. It highlights the role of quantum physics in daily life and future technology.

120. The Indian Athletics Series 4 was held in which city?

- [A] Ranchi
- [B] Patna
- [C] Bhopal
- [D] Lucknow

Answer: Ranchi

The Indian Athletics Series 4 was held at Birsa Munda Stadium, Ranchi with participation of more than 200 athletes. The event was organised by the Athletics Federation of India in association with the Jharkhand Athletics Association. Competitions were held across senior men's, women's, and under-20 categories, covering 38 track and field events. Events included sprints, middle- and long-distance races, hurdles, and jumping and throwing disciplines. Athletes from institutions like Railways and the Army contributed to a highly competitive environment. The event served as an important platform for performance assessment ahead of national and international competitions.

121. Where was first BRICS Health Working Group Meeting 2026 held?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Bengaluru

Answer: New Delhi

The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare chaired the First Health Working Group meeting under the BRICS framework in New Delhi in 2026. The meeting brought together representatives from nine BRICS countries, including Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, UAE, and Indonesia. India, as BRICS Chair 2026, adopted the theme "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability." It focused on strengthening cooperation in public health, including communicable and non-communicable diseases and health systems. India proposed new priorities of promoting healthy lifestyles and improving mental health and wellness.

122. Which institution launched Super Sales Saathi App (for intermediaries) to enhance digital insurance services?

- [A] Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India
- [B] Life Insurance Corporation of India
- [C] State Bank of India
- [D] Reserve Bank of India

Answer: Life Insurance Corporation of India

Life Insurance Corporation of India launched MyLIC App (for customers) and Super Sales Saathi App (for intermediaries) to enhance digital insurance services. LIC manages over 260 million policies, highlighting its vast insurance footprint in India. MyLIC App offers a



360° digital platform with services like premium payment, policy tracking, e-KYC (electronic Know Your Customer), claims support, and paperless loans. It enables users to revive lapsed policies and purchase insurance online seamlessly. Super Sales Saathi App provides digital tools for agents, including performance dashboards, AI-based insights, and real-time tracking.

123. Sakurajima Volcano, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Indonesia
- [B] China
- [C] Japan
- [D] Mexico

Answer: Japan

Sakurajima Volcano is located on the southern tip of Kyushu Island near Kagoshima city in Japan. It is one of Japan's most active stratovolcanoes, with frequent eruptions of varying intensity. It is an andesitic volcano with high viscosity magma and high gas content, leading to explosive eruptions. It lies on a convergent plate boundary and forms part of the Aira Caldera system. The volcano consists of two main peaks: Kitadake (north) and Minamidake (south). Recent eruptions have sent large ash plumes, impacting nearby regions.

124. Which state is the host of 87th Inter-State Junior and Youth National Table Tennis Championship 2026?

- [A] Bihar
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Uttarakhand
- [D] Himachal Pradesh

Answer: Uttarakhand

Uttarakhand Pushkar Singh Dhami inaugurated the 87th Inter-State Junior and Youth National Table Tennis Championship 2026 in Dehradun. The event was held at the Multipurpose Sports Hall, Parade Ground, marking Uttarakhand's first time hosting this national-level tournament. Uttarakhand is emerging as a sports hub, with strong performance in the 38th National Games (103 medals).

125. Where was Sri Guru Bhairavaikya Mandira inaugurated in April 2026?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Tamil Nadu
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Karnataka

Narendra Modi inaugurated the Sri Guru Bhairavaikya Mandira at Sri Adichunchanagiri Mahasamsthana Math in Mandya district, Karnataka. The temple was described as a symbol of India's spiritual heritage, service, and wisdom traditions. During the visit, the Prime Minister offered prayers at Jwala Peetha and Sri Kalabhairava Temple. He paid tribute to Balagangadharanatha Mahaswamiji, recognising his contributions to spirituality



and social service. The Math is known for its work in education, healthcare, and social welfare, reflecting Karnataka's cultural heritage.

126. Which state government introduced a QR code-based passenger feedback system in April 2026 to improve service quality?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Bihar

Answer: Gujarat

The Gujarat State Road Transport Corporation introduced a QR code-based passenger feedback system in April 2026 to improve service quality. Passengers can scan QR codes installed in buses to rate services, register complaints, and upload feedback in real time. The initiative ensures quick grievance redressal, as seen when odour complaints in AC and Volvo buses were resolved promptly. GSRTC recorded an average passenger satisfaction rating of 4.5/5 based on 1,702 responses in March 2026.

127. The Bacille Calmette-Guérin (BCG) vaccine is a live attenuated vaccine used to protect against which disease?

- [A] Japanese Encephalitis
- [B] Tuberculosis
- [C] Dengue
- [D] Malaria

Answer: Tuberculosis

India supplied 13 tonnes of Bacille Calmette-Guérin (BCG) vaccines and related materials to Afghanistan's Ministry of Public Health. The Bacille Calmette-Guérin (BCG) vaccine is a live attenuated vaccine used to protect against tuberculosis (TB). It is the only licensed vaccine for TB and is widely administered to newborns worldwide. The vaccine was developed by Albert Calmette and Camille Guérin at the Pasteur Institute and first used in 1921. Its main aim is to prevent severe childhood TB, including TB meningitis and disseminated TB. It also provides partial protection against diseases like leprosy and Buruli ulcer.

128. The "Nari Shakti Vandan Run" is organised by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [B] Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
- [C] Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- [D] Ministry of Home Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports organised a nationwide "Nari Shakti Vandan Run". The event was held across seven cities: Delhi, Cuttack, Patna, Mumbai, Indore, Bengaluru, and Jaipur. It aimed to promote women-led development and citizen participation under the vision of Viksit Bharat. The run covered 2–3 km at prominent public locations, with participation from students, professionals, and sportspersons. It was supported by



organisations like National Service Scheme, Sports Authority of India, and MY Bharat. The initiative coincided with the special session of Parliament (16–18 April 2026) focusing on women's representation and delimitation.

129. The National Backward Classes Finance & Development Corporation operates under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Tribal Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment

The National Backward Classes Finance and Development Corporation, under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, works for socio-economic upliftment of Other Backward Classes (OBCs). In FY 2025–26, it achieved a record disbursement of ₹613.75 crore, benefiting 61,621 beneficiaries. Under the VISVAS Interest Subvention Scheme, ₹35.20 crore was utilised, supporting 1.92 lakh beneficiaries with loans worth ₹2,720 crore. The National Fellowship for OBCs disbursed ₹123.33 crore to 2,505 students. Under the SEED (Scheme for Economic Empowerment of Denotified, Nomadic and Semi-Nomadic Tribes), ₹19.20 crore supported 28,476 beneficiaries.

130. Veli-Akkulam Estuary is located in which state?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Tamil Nadu
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Kerala

The Veli-Akkulam Estuary is located along the coast of Thiruvananthapuram in Kerala. It is a small, shallow, bar-built estuary forming part of the Kerala backwater system adjoining the Lakshadweep Sea. The estuary is divided by a man-made bund into two parts: Veli (west) and Akkulam (northeast). Its connection to the sea is intermittent, opening mainly during the monsoon through sandbar breaching. It is currently facing degradation due to invasive species, pollution, urban runoff, and encroachment, impacting biodiversity.

131. Balikatan Exercise is the largest bilateral military exercise between the United States and which country?

- [A] Philippines
- [B] Australia
- [C] Japan
- [D] France

Answer: Philippines

Balikatan Exercise is the largest bilateral military drill between the Armed Forces of the Philippines and the United States Armed Forces. The term "Balikatan" means "shoulder-to-shoulder," symbolising the strong alliance between the Philippines and the United States. It is conducted annually, with the first edition held in 2001. The 2026 exercise (41st edition)



will be held from 20 April to 8 May 2026. Around 17,000 troops from seven countries—Philippines, USA, Australia, Japan, Canada, France, and New Zealand—will participate. The exercise aims to enhance regional security through joint operations and interoperability.

132. Which ministry launched the Urban Challenge Fund (UCF) and Credit Repayment Guarantee Sub-Scheme (CRGSS)?

- [A] Ministry of Rural Development
- [B] Ministry of Finance
- [C] Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs launched the Urban Challenge Fund (UCF) and Credit Repayment Guarantee Sub-Scheme (CRGSS) in New Delhi. The Urban Challenge Fund has a total Central assistance of ₹1 lakh crore, aimed at boosting urban infrastructure financing. It promotes market-based financing, with only 25% central funding and at least 50% through bonds, loans, and public-private partnerships (PPP).

133. What is "Dillenia nagalim" that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Newly discovered plant species
- [B] A type of virus
- [C] Newly discovered species of Fish
- [D] Traditional medicine

Answer: Newly discovered plant species

Dillenia nagalim is a new plant species discovered in Kamjong district of Manipur near the Indo-Myanmar border. The name reflects the Naga community, indicating its local origin. It is endemic, currently known from only a single location. It is a small shrub with bright yellow flowers and double-serrated leaves. It differs from related species like Dillenia pentagyna in size, flower structure, and reproductive features. It grows in tropical deciduous forests (250–350 m altitude) and flowers during May–June.

134. The Painted Leopard Gecko is a rare, colourful terrestrial reptile recently spotted in which state?

- [A] Bihar
- [B] Jharkhand
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Chhattisgarh

Answer: Chhattisgarh

The Painted Leopard Gecko (*Eublepharis pictus*) is a rare, colourful terrestrial reptile recently spotted in Bastar, Chhattisgarh. It belongs to the genus *Eublepharis* under the family Eublepharidae, distributed across Asia, Africa, and the Americas. The species was scientifically described in 2022 from the Eastern Ghats of Andhra Pradesh and Odisha. The Brahmani River acts as a geographical barrier separating it from the East Indian Leopard Gecko. It prefers dry evergreen forests with scrub and meadow habitats.



135. "Ayush Chintan Shivir 2026" was inaugurated in which city?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Mumbai
- [C] Chennai
- [D] Hyderabad

Answer: New Delhi

Shri Prataprao Jadhav, Minister of State (Independent Charge), Ministry of Ayush inaugurated "Chintan Shivir 2026" in New Delhi (2-day event ending 17 April 2026). The event aims to review progress, identify gaps, and plan a future roadmap for the AYUSH (Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Homeopathy) sector. It emphasises evidence-based traditional medicine and integration with modern healthcare systems. The Ministry launched a WhatsApp channel and a toll-free number (1800-11-0008) for public engagement. The initiative aligns with the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047 and promotes "Heal in India, Heal by India."

136. What is the IUCN conservation status of Tibetan antelope, that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Near Threatened

Answer: Near Threatened

A New Delhi court convicted an art gallery owner for attempting to illegally export Shahtoosh shawls, made from the Tibetan Antelope. The Tibetan antelope (chiru) is a medium-sized migratory antelope, with males having horns and black leg stripes. It has a fine undercoat (Shahtoosh wool) beneath long guard hair, making it highly prized and endangered. It inhabits cold alpine and steppe regions of Tibet, Xinjiang, Qinghai (China), and Changthang (Ladakh, India). It is a migratory species, travelling up to 400 km between seasonal habitats. It is classified as Near Threatened on the IUCN Red List.

137. Who became the first Indian woman to win the Women's Candidates Chess Tournament 2026?

- [A] Divya Deshmukh
- [B] Koneru Humpy
- [C] Harika Dronavalli
- [D] R Vaishali

Answer: R Vaishali

R Vaishali became the first Indian woman to win the Women's Candidates Tournament (2026). She secured the title by defeating Kateryna Lagno in the final round, finishing with 8.5/14 points. Vaishali will now challenge Ju Wenjun for the Women's World Chess Championship. Her victory marks a historic milestone for Indian chess, following Gukesh Dommaraju's earlier success in the Open Candidates.

138. World Hemophilia Day is observed on which day every year?

- [A] April 16



[B] April 17

[C] April 18

[D] April 19

Answer: April 17

World Hemophilia Day is observed on 17 April to raise awareness about bleeding disorders. It is led by the World Federation of Hemophilia. The theme for 2026 is "Diagnosis: First Step to Care", emphasising early detection and treatment. It highlights that over 75% of hemophilia cases remain undiagnosed globally. Awareness campaigns include "Light it up Red", where landmarks are illuminated to show support. The initiative promotes equitable access to diagnosis and treatment for inherited bleeding disorders.

139. According to the latest International Monetary Fund estimates (2025–26), what is India's rank in global GDP (nominal terms)?

[A] Third

[B] Fourth

[C] Fifth

[D] Sixth

Answer: Sixth

The International Monetary Fund (World Economic Outlook, April 2026) ranked India as the 6th largest economy in 2025–26. India's GDP is estimated at \$3.92 trillion, behind the United Kingdom (\$4 trillion) and Japan (\$4.44 trillion). The decline in rank is statistical, not due to weak growth, as India remains one of the fastest-growing economies. The main reason is rupee depreciation, since GDP is measured in US dollar terms, reducing India's relative size. A revision of GDP base year (2011–12 to 2022–23) also lowered nominal GDP estimates. India is projected to regain 4th position by 2027 and surpass Japan by 2028, becoming the 3rd largest economy by 2031.

140. World Voice Day is observed on which day every year?

[A] April 16

[B] April 17

[C] April 18

[D] April 19

Answer: April 16

World Voice Day is observed on 16 April to highlight the importance of the human voice in communication and expression. The theme for 2026 is "Caring for Our Voices". It emphasises vocal health through hydration, avoiding strain, and early diagnosis of disorders. The initiative aims to raise awareness about voice disorders, promote preventive care, and reduce stigma.

141. Peter Magyar has become the new Prime Minister of which country?

[A] Hungary

[B] Cyprus

[C] Spain

[D] Sweden

**Answer: Hungary**

Peter Magyar has become the new Prime Minister of Hungary after winning the 2026 elections. He defeated long-time leader Viktor Orbán, ending his 16-year rule and bid for a fifth term. Magyar's Tisza Party secured a two-thirds majority, marking a historic electoral victory. The election saw high voter turnout, driven by concerns over corruption and governance. Magyar has promised to restore democratic institutions, strengthen ties with the EU and NATO, and address corruption.

142. Viktor Axelsen, who recently announced his retirement, is associated with which sports?

- [A] Basketball
- [B] Boxing
- [C] Badminton
- [D] Wrestling

Answer: Badminton

Viktor Axelsen announced his retirement from professional badminton on 15 April 2026 due to recurring back injuries. He is a two-time Olympic gold medallist (2020, 2024) and among the greatest players in badminton history. Axelsen became only the second player after Lin Dan to successfully defend an Olympic title. His career highlights include World Championship titles (2017, 2022) and All England titles (2020, 2022).

143. A new species of bent-toed gecko named *Cyrtodactylus jayadityai* was recently discovered in which state?

- [A] Tripura
- [B] Assam
- [C] Manipur
- [D] Mizoram

Answer: Tripura

Researchers recently discovered a new bent-toed gecko species, *Cyrtodactylus jayadityai*, in Tripura, highlighting Northeast India's rich biodiversity. The species inhabits lowland forest patches, emphasizing the ecological value of these habitats. It is genetically distinct, showing about 4.7–5.2 percent divergence from its closest relative, *Cyrtodactylus tripuraensis*, based on mitochondrial Deoxyribonucleic Acid (DNA) analysis. The gecko is nocturnal, becoming active at night for foraging and hiding in burrows during the day. With this discovery, the total number of *Cyrtodactylus* species in Northeast India has increased to 31.

144. Which university has developed a hafnium-oxide memristor for reducing AI energy use?

- [A] Harvard University
- [B] Stanford University
- [C] University of Cambridge
- [D] Banaras Hindu University

Answer: University of Cambridge

Researchers from the University of Cambridge have developed a hafnium-oxide memristor, a brain-inspired nanodevice that can significantly reduce Artificial Intelligence



(AI) energy consumption. A memristor (memory + resistor) is an electronic component whose resistance depends on past current flow, enabling it to “remember” previous electrical states. Unlike a conventional resistor, a memristor has variable resistance and retains its state even when the current is switched off. Memristors are nanoscale devices with low energy requirements and are commonly made using materials like titanium dioxide (TiO₂) between metal electrodes.

145. Lakhwar Hydroelectric Project is located in which state?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Uttarakhand

North India's water and energy security will improve as the 300 megawatt Lakhwar Hydroelectric Project on the Yamuna River in Uttarakhand progresses after review by the Ministry of Jal Shakti. The Lakhwar project is a multipurpose hydroelectric project located near Lohari village in Dehradun district and is being developed by Uttarakhand Jal Vidyut Nigam. It includes a 204 metre high concrete gravity dam, three steel-lined penstocks, and an underground powerhouse with three vertical Francis turbines of 100 megawatts each.

146. RELIEF Scheme was launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [B] Ministry of Finance
- [C] Ministry of Urban Development
- [D] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Answer: Ministry of Commerce and Industry

The Government has expanded the RELIEF (Resilience and Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation) scheme under the Export Promotion Mission (EPM) due to geopolitical disruptions in West Asia affecting maritime trade. The RELIEF scheme, launched by Ministry of Commerce & Industry in March 2026. It provides support to Indian exporters facing high freight costs, increased insurance premiums, and war-related risks in the Gulf region. It is implemented through the Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India as the nodal agency, focusing on insurance facilitation and risk coverage.

147. Which coaching depot of Gujarat has become India's first 'water neutral' railway depot?

- [A] Ranavav Integrated Coaching Depot
- [B] Kankaria Coaching Depot
- [C] Integrated Coaching Depot
- [D] Okha Coaching Depot

Answer: Kankaria Coaching Depot

Kankaria Coaching Depot in Ahmedabad, Gujarat, has become India's first water-neutral railway coaching depot, marking a major step in sustainable railway operations. The depot achieves water neutrality by treating and reusing wastewater generated from coach washing and maintenance activities. It saves around 1.60 lakh litres of water daily,



significantly reducing dependence on freshwater resources. The system uses phytoremediation (plant-based treatment) along with filtration and disinfection to recycle water efficiently. This initiative by Indian Railways promotes environmental conservation, cost efficiency, and serves as a model for green infrastructure.

148. Who has been elected as the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha for the third consecutive term?

- [A] Najma Heptulla
- [B] Sanjay Kumar
- [C] Sanjay Kumar Jha
- [D] Harivansh Narayan Singh

Answer: Harivansh Narayan Singh

Harivansh Narayan Singh has been elected Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha for the third consecutive term, and was elected unopposed. He is the first nominated member to hold this position, having been nominated by Droupadi Murmu after the retirement of Ranjan Gogoi. The motion for his election was moved by J. P. Nadda, Leader of the House in the Rajya Sabha. His unanimous election reflects consensus and cooperation in Indian parliamentary democracy and confidence across party lines.

149. Hokersar Lake, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state/UT?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Himachal Pradesh
- [C] Jammu and Kashmir
- [D] Lakshadweep

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

The Comptroller and Auditor General of India has warned about severe ecological degradation of Hokersar Lake, with over 2,500 kanals encroached. Hokersar Lake is a natural wetland near Srinagar in Jammu and Kashmir, spread over 13.75 square kilometres at an altitude of about 1,585 metres. It lies in the Jhelum River basin and is mainly fed by the Doodhganga River, a tributary of the Jhelum. It is the largest bird sanctuary in Kashmir Valley and a Ramsar site, hosting around 68 species of migratory waterfowl from Siberia, Central Asia, and Northern Europe.

150. World Heritage Day (International Day for Monuments and Sites) is observed every year on which day?

- [A] April 16
- [B] April 17
- [C] April 18
- [D] April 19

Answer: April 18

World Heritage Day (International Day for Monuments and Sites) is observed on April 18 every year. The theme for 2026 is "Emergency Response for Living Heritage in Contexts of Conflicts and Disasters," highlighting the protection of cultural treasures. It is a global initiative to promote awareness of heritage diversity. The International Council on



Monuments and Sites (ICOMOS) organizes this day, first observed in 1983, to promote protecting cultural heritage.

151. Which month is observed as Parkinson's Disease Awareness Month?

- [A] April
- [B] May
- [C] June
- [D] July

Answer: April

April is observed as Parkinson's Disease Awareness Month, highlighting the importance of early diagnosis and support systems for patients and caregivers. Parkinson's disease is a progressive neurological disorder, often diagnosed late as early symptoms are overlooked or misunderstood. The three main motor symptoms are tremors (shaking), slowness of movement, and rigidity (muscle stiffness). Non-motor symptoms such as constipation and sleep disorders may appear years before motor symptoms, contributing to delayed diagnosis. There is no cure, but early detection and treatment can help manage symptoms and improve quality of life.

152. Astra Mark-2 missile is developed by which organisation?

- [A] Indian Space Research Organisation
- [B] Defence Research and Development Organisation
- [C] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited
- [D] Bharat Electronics Limited

Answer: Defence Research and Development Organisation

India plans to equip Dassault Mirage 2000 jets with Astra Mark-2 missiles, enhancing interception up to 240 kilometres and boosting aerial dominance. Astra Mark-2 is a Beyond Visual Range (BVR) air-to-air missile, developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO). More than 50 industries, including Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL), contributed to its development. Astra Mark-1 (90–100 kilometres range) is already inducted in the Indian Air Force (IAF) on LCA Tejas and Su-30 MKI.

153. The Tharu tribe is mainly found in which Indian states?

- [A] Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Bihar
- [B] Rajasthan and Gujarat
- [C] Assam, Manipur and Mizoram
- [D] Odisha, Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand

Answer: Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Bihar

The Allahabad High Court (Lucknow Bench) set aside rejection of Community Forest Rights claims of the Tharu tribe in Lakhimpur Kheri. The Tharu are an indigenous tribe of the Terai plains along the Indo-Nepal border, residing in Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Bihar. They are among the oldest and largest ethnic groups of the Terai and were recognized as a Scheduled Tribe in 1967. Their language, Tharu or Tharuhati, belongs to the Indo-Aryan subgroup of the Indo-European language family. Economy is based on



agriculture, cattle rearing, fishing, hunting, and forest produce collection.

154. The Chenchu tribe is primarily found in which forest region?

- [A] Sundarbans Forests
- [B] Nallamala Forests
- [C] Western Ghats Forests
- [D] Aravalli Forests

Answer: Nallamala Forests

Chenchu tribals in Amrabad Tiger Reserve opposed relocation citing forest-based livelihood concerns. The Chenchu are a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG) mainly living in Nallamalai forests of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. They are classified under the Proto-Australoid group and also inhabit Karnataka and Odisha. Settlements called “Penta” consist of scattered huts based on kinship; “Peddamanishi” acts as village head. Society is based on small families with relatively equal gender roles and marriage at maturity.

155. What is the name of the recently launched domestic maritime insurance mechanism scheme to safeguard India’s seaborne trade?

- [A] Sagarmala Insurance Scheme
- [B] National Shipping Protection Scheme
- [C] Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool
- [D] Marine Trade Security Mission

Answer: Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool

The Government of India has launched the Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMI Pool) to safeguard seaborne trade from global disruptions. It is a Centre-backed domestic maritime insurance mechanism ensuring affordable and uninterrupted coverage for shipping. The scheme covers Indian-flagged vessels, Indian-controlled ships, and vessels carrying cargo to or from India, including high-risk routes. It provides comprehensive risk coverage including hull and machinery, cargo, protection and indemnity, and war risk insurance. The BMI Pool will operate initially for 10 years, with a provision for a five-year extension.

156. Mogrus shushka and Mogrus pune, that were recently seen in news, belongs to which species?

- [A] Spider
- [B] Frog
- [C] Ant
- [D] Snake

Answer: Spider

Scientists discovered two new jumping spider species—Mogrus shushka and Mogrus pune—belonging to the genus Mogrus, found in arid and urban ecosystems. Mogrus shushka was identified in Desert National Park, adapted to extreme heat, low humidity, and sandy terrain of the Thar Desert. Its name is derived from the Sanskrit word “shushka,” meaning dry, reflecting its habitat conditions. Mogrus pune was discovered in



Alfa Laval Biodiversity Park and named after Pune city. These spiders belong to jumping spiders (family Salticidae), known for keen vision and agile hunting. The discovery highlights India's biodiversity richness across both desert ecosystems and urban green spaces.

157. Which institute has established the Vikram Sodhi Centre of Excellence for Artificial Intelligence-enabled geological and mining systems?

- [A] IIT Ahmedabad
- [B] IIT Bombay
- [C] IIT Kharagpur
- [D] IIT Roorkee

Answer: IIT Kharagpur

The Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur has established the Vikram Sodhi Centre of Excellence for Artificial Intelligence-enabled geological and mining systems. The centre is funded with ₹15 crore over five years by Vikram Sodhi, Vice Chairman of Mineros SA. It aims to develop Artificial Intelligence-based solutions tailored to Indian geological and mining conditions. The initiative focuses on integrating the entire mining value chain including exploration, planning, processing, safety, and environmental management.

158. The 'Vishwa Sutra' initiative is associated with which sector?

- [A] Agriculture
- [B] Textile and Handloom
- [C] Tourism
- [D] Information Technology

Answer: Textile and Handloom

The Ministry of Textiles launched the 'Vishwa Sutra – Weaves of India for the World' initiative to globalise Indian handlooms. It was showcased at the 61st Femina Miss India held in Bhubaneswar, Odisha. The initiative is developed by the Office of the Development Commissioner (Handlooms) in collaboration with the National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT). It brings together 30 handloom weaves from different Indian states, each reinterpreted with design inspirations from 30 countries. The objective is to present Indian textiles in a contemporary global design framework and enhance international appeal.

159. Kulsi River, that was recently seen in news, is a south-bank tributary of which river?

- [A] Ganga
- [B] Yamuna
- [C] Brahmaputra
- [D] Narmada

Answer: Brahmaputra

A proposed hydropower project on the Kulsi River is facing opposition from local residents due to ecological concerns. The Kulsi River is a south-bank tributary of the Brahmaputra River. It originates from the West Khasi Hills of Meghalaya through three streams—Khri, Krishniya, and Umsiri. The river is called Khri in the upper reaches and later flows



northwest, entering Assam at Ukium. It flows through Kamrup district and joins the Brahmaputra near Nagarbera.

160. World Liver Day is observed annually on which day?

- [A] April 18
- [B] April 19
- [C] April 20
- [D] April 21

Answer: April 19

World Liver Day is observed annually on 19 April to raise awareness about liver diseases and their prevention. The liver is the second-largest organ and performs vital functions such as metabolism, detoxification, digestion, immunity, and nutrient storage. Despite its ability to regenerate up to 60–70%, liver damage can lead to serious conditions like cirrhosis and cancer. Globally, about 2 million deaths occur annually due to liver diseases, including cirrhosis, viral hepatitis, and liver cancer. The theme for 2026 is “Solid Habits, Strong Liver,” emphasising healthy lifestyle, balanced diet, exercise, and regular health check-ups.

161. Which organization launched the ‘Water Forward’ initiative in April 2026 to enhance global water security?

- [A] World Bank
- [B] United Nations Environment Programme
- [C] International Monetary Fund
- [D] United Nations Development Programme

Answer: World Bank

The World Bank Group launched the ‘Water Forward’ initiative on 15 April 2026 to enhance global water security. It aims to improve access to safe and reliable water for 1 billion people by 2030 through global partnerships. The initiative is led in collaboration with multilateral development banks and development finance institutions. It focuses on expanding water services and strengthening resilience against droughts and floods. It adopts country-led water compacts integrating policy reforms, financing, partnerships, and investment-ready projects.

162. Which institute is the host of India’s first Centre of Excellence on Plant Cell Fermentation Technology?

- [A] IIT Chennai
- [B] IIT Ahmedabad
- [C] IIT Bombay
- [D] IIT Madras

Answer: IIT Madras

Herbalife India and Indian Institute of Technology Madras signed a Memorandum of Understanding on 17 April 2026 to establish a new research facility. The initiative sets up India’s first Centre of Excellence on Plant Cell Fermentation Technology at IIT Madras Research Park, Chennai. The centre aims to promote research, innovation, and



entrepreneurship in sustainable production of herbal biomass and phytochemicals. It focuses on plant cell fermentation for scalable and eco-friendly production of compounds for health and wellness.

163. Amchang Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which city?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Manipur
- [C] Sikkim
- [D] Tripura

Answer: Assam

The Gauhati High Court directed the Assam government to respond to a petition regarding tree felling in the sanctuary without central forest clearance. Amchang Wildlife Sanctuary is located on the eastern fringe of Guwahati city, Assam. It was formed by merging South Amchang Reserve Forest, Amchang Reserve Forest, and Khanapara Reserve Forest. The sanctuary extends from the Brahmaputra River in the north to the forested hills of Meghalaya in the south.

164. The Muthuvan tribe is primarily found in which region?

- [A] Eastern Himalayas
- [B] Eastern Ghats
- [C] Chotanagpur Plateau
- [D] Western Ghats

Answer: Western Ghats

A report by the Kerala State Food Commission highlighted discrepancies in ration distribution in Edamalakkudy, Kerala's only tribal panchayat inhabited by the Muthuvan tribe. The Muthuvan tribe resides in the Western Ghats across Kerala and Tamil Nadu. They speak the Muthuvan language, belonging to the Dravidian language family, with dialects like Malayalam Muthuvan and Pandi Muthuvan. They are known for harmonious coexistence with wildlife and deep ecological knowledge of hill ecosystems. The tribe possesses traditional medicinal knowledge passed down through generations.

165. India's first Petroglyph Conservation Park is being established in which state/UT?

- [A] Himachal Pradesh
- [B] Ladakh
- [C] Uttarakhand
- [D] Delhi

Answer: Ladakh

India's first Petroglyph Conservation Park is being established in Ladakh on the banks of the Indus River to preserve ancient rock art. Petroglyphs are prehistoric carvings or engravings on rock surfaces depicting symbols, figures, and inscriptions. The park aims to protect endangered petroglyphs threatened by tourism, infrastructure development, and environmental factors. It will relocate and conserve carvings from vulnerable and isolated sites across Ladakh for safe preservation and public display.

166. The Colorado River, that was recently seen in news, forms an international boundary between



which two regions?

- [A] California and Mexico
- [B] Arizona and Mexico
- [C] Nevada and Mexico
- [D] Utah and Mexico

Answer: Arizona and Mexico

The Colorado River is a major river of North America, often called the “Lifeline of the Southwest.” It originates in the Rocky Mountains of Colorado, United States, and flows about 1,450 miles (2,330 kilometres) into the Gulf of California in Mexico. The river flows through seven U.S. states and two Mexican states, draining a vast arid and semi-arid region. It also forms part of the international boundary between Arizona (USA) and Mexico. It forms major reservoirs such as Lake Mead and Lake Powell, crucial for water supply and hydropower. Recent research highlights changing hydrological patterns, explaining declining water levels in the river system.

167. Civil Services Day in India is observed annually on which day?

- [A] April 18
- [B] April 19
- [C] April 20
- [D] April 21

Answer: April 21

Civil Services Day in India is observed annually on April 21. Civil Services Day commemorates Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel’s 1947 address, where he described civil servants as the “steel frame of India.” The day aims to reaffirm commitment of civil servants towards citizen-centric governance and public service excellence. The theme for 2026 is “Viksit Bharat: Citizen-Centric Governance and Development at the Last Mile.” The theme aligns with the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, focusing on transparency, accountability, and inclusive development.

168. Pelusium, that was recently seen in news, is an ancient city located in which country?

- [A] Egypt
- [B] Iran
- [C] Israel
- [D] Turkey

Answer: Egypt

Excavations at Tell el-Farama in northern Sinai revealed a rare round temple in the ancient city of Pelusium. Pelusium was located at the easternmost mouth of the Nile, about 32 km southeast of Port Said in Egypt. It was originally known as Sainu or Per-Amun and served as a key fortress and customs post on Egypt’s eastern frontier. The city was famous for flax production and held strong economic importance.

169. Which state has become the first in India to launch a Marine Spatial Plan (MSP) for integrated coastal management?

- [A] Rajasthan



- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Madhya Pradesh

Answer: Odisha

Odisha has become the first Indian state to launch a Marine Spatial Plan (MSP) for integrated coastal management. MSP is a strategic tool for sustainable use and efficient management of marine and coastal resources. The plan is being implemented by the Odisha Government in collaboration with the National Centre for Coastal Research under the Ministry of Earth Sciences. It aims to balance economic activities like fishing, tourism, and shipping with environmental conservation.

170. Designer rice has been developed by which institute?

- [A] ICAR-Indian Agricultural Research Institute, New Delhi
- [B] CSIR-National Institute for Interdisciplinary Science and Technology
- [C] CSIR-Central Food Technological Research Institute
- [D] National Institute of Nutrition

Answer: CSIR-National Institute for Interdisciplinary Science and Technology

Scientists at CSIR National Institute for Interdisciplinary Science and Technology have developed "Designer Rice," a functional food to address malnutrition. It is created by processing broken rice into flour, enriching it with protein, fibre, and micronutrients like iron, folic acid, and vitamin B12, and reforming it into rice-like grains. The technology has been transferred to Tata Consumer Products Limited for large-scale production. Unlike regular rice, it has higher protein (over 20%) and a low glycemic index (below 55). It helps manage blood sugar levels, making it beneficial for diabetics.

171. Amber Fort, that was recently seen in news, is located in which city?

- [A] Agra
- [B] Jaipur
- [C] Indore
- [D] Chennai

Answer: Jaipur

The Rajasthan High Court issued notices regarding alleged illegal elephant rides near Amber Fort. Amber Fort (Amer Fort) is located about 11 km from Jaipur in Rajasthan. It was built in the late 16th century by Raja Man Singh I, a general of Akbar. The fort is situated on the Aravalli hills, providing strategic and scenic advantage. Amer served as the capital of the Kachwaha Rajputs before Jaipur was established. The fort showcases a blend of Rajput and Mughal architectural styles.

172. R-37M Missile was developed by which country?

- [A] Israel
- [B] Australia
- [C] Russia
- [D] North Korea

Answer: Russia



Russia has approved the sale of the R-37M (Russian long-range air-to-air missile), also known as AA-13 Axehead (North Atlantic Treaty Organization reporting name), to India to enhance its air combat capability. The missile is designed for BVR (Beyond Visual Range) combat, allowing it to strike targets at very long distances without direct visual contact. It is developed to destroy enemy fighter jets, drones, and other aerial threats effectively. The missile is nicknamed an “AWACS (Airborne Warning and Control System) Killer” because it can target high-value aircraft like radar planes, refuelling tankers, and jamming systems.

173. The Salween River, that was recently seen in news, originates from which region?

- [A] Karakoram Range
- [B] Tibetan Plateau (Eastern Himalayas)
- [C] Arakan Yoma
- [D] Western Ghats

Answer: Tibetan Plateau (Eastern Himalayas)

The Salween River, also called the Nu River in China and Thanlwin in Myanmar, is a transboundary river shared by China, Myanmar, and Thailand, recently facing arsenic pollution from mining in Myanmar. It is about 2400 km long and is the longest free-flowing (undammed) river in mainland Southeast Asia. The river originates in the Tibetan region of the eastern Himalayas at around 4,000 meters and flows through Yunnan, Myanmar, and along the Myanmar–Thailand border before draining into the Gulf of Martaban in the Andaman Sea. Its upper course runs parallel to the Mekong and Yangtze rivers, forming the Three Parallel Rivers of Yunnan.

174. The Market Intervention Scheme (MIS) is a component of which initiative?

- [A] PM-KISAN
- [B] PM-AASHA
- [C] e-NAM
- [D] National Food Security Mission

Answer: PM-AASHA

The Market Intervention Scheme is a component of Pradhan Mantri Annadata Aay Sanrakshan Abhiyan (PM-AASHA), under which the government recently approved procurement of 20 lakh metric tonnes of potatoes. The scheme is implemented at the request of State or Union Territory governments to procure perishable crops like tomato, onion, and potato that do not have a Minimum Support Price. Its objective is to protect farmers from distress sales during bumper production when market prices fall below the cost of production. It is implemented by the Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.

175. Uiam Lake, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- [A] Arunachal Pradesh
- [B] Assam
- [C] Sikkim
- [D] Meghalaya

Answer: Meghalaya



The government of Meghalaya has decided to exclude Lumpondeng Island located in Umiam Lake from the proposed luxury resort project after protests by local communities and stakeholders. The Umiam Lake, also known as Barapani Lake, is a man-made reservoir located about 15 km north of Shillong and surrounded by the East Khasi Hills. The lake is formed by a dam built across the Umiam River, a tributary of the Brahmaputra River, with a capacity to generate about 60 MW of electricity.

176. According to a report by Boston Consulting Group, which country has the highest adoption of AI in personal healthcare?

- [A] United States
- [B] United Kingdom
- [C] India
- [D] Japan

Answer: India

India has become a global leader in adopting artificial intelligence in healthcare, with 85% of consumers using AI-powered tools, according to a report by Boston Consulting Group. The report highlights that India's adoption rate is much higher than countries like the United States (50%), United Kingdom (43%), and Japan (34%). Globally, about 60% of people use AI for health purposes, but India stands out due to higher digital acceptance and rapid adoption.

177. Garia Puja is primarily celebrated in which state?

- [A] Tripura
- [B] Manipur
- [C] Assam
- [D] Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: Tripura

Garia Puja is celebrated across Tripura with participation from both tribal and non-tribal communities, promoting harmony and welfare. The festival is dedicated to Baba Garia, a deity associated with prosperity, livestock, and well-being in tribal traditions. Devotees offer bamboo poles decorated with leaves, threads, cloth, along with flowers and fruits as part of rituals. Major celebrations are held in Agartala and at Garjantoli in Teliamura under the initiative of the Jamatia Hoda.

178. As per Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade data, which Indian state received the highest FDI inflows?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Tamil Nadu

Answer: Maharashtra

Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade data shows that Singapore was the top source of FDI (Foreign Direct Investment) equity inflows into India during April–December FY26, contributing \$17.6 billion (37%). The United States (16%) and



Mauritius (10%) were the next major contributors, followed by Japan and the UAE. India received a total of \$47.87 billion in FDI equity inflows during this period. The top sectors attracting FDI were Computer Software & Hardware (22%) and Services (Financial, Banking, R&D) at 18%. Among states, Maharashtra received the highest inflows, followed by Karnataka.

179. The Para Elan initiative has been jointly launched by India and which country?

- [A] Germany
- [B] Japan
- [C] France
- [D] Australia

Answer: France

The Para Elan initiative is a three-year India–France collaboration launched by the French Institute in India and the Paralympic Committee of India to promote inclusive education and para sports. A Memorandum of Understanding was signed by Satya Prakash Sangwan (PCI) and Gregor Trumel (IFI) in the presence of Thierry Mathou. The programme aims to reach around 10,000 students through awareness campaigns, workshops, and interactions with para-athletes. It focuses on values like inclusion, equality, resilience, and excellence while strengthening India–France cooperation in adaptive sports.

180. Who has become India's 95th GM (Grandmaster)?

- [A] Aronyak Ghosh
- [B] Virendra Garg
- [C] Vaibhav Jha
- [D] Samyak Sinha

Answer: Aronyak Ghosh

Aronyak Ghosh has become India's 95th GM (Grandmaster) after achieving his final norm at the Bangkok Chess Club Open with a score of 7/9. He secured his third and final GM norm after a four-year journey since his first norm, showcasing persistence and consistency. Known for creative and unconventional opening strategies, he gained attention for his unique playing style and victories against strong opponents. He earlier won a bronze medal at the U-16 World Youth Championship and also at the Pune National Championship (2023) via the Buchholz tie-break system.

181. World Creativity and Innovation Day is observed annually on which day?

- [A] April 19
- [B] April 20
- [C] April 21
- [D] April 22

Answer: April 21

World Creativity and Innovation Day is observed annually on April 21 to highlight the role of creativity and innovation in addressing global challenges. Recognized by the United Nations, it emphasizes that creativity is crucial for sustainable development, economic growth, and social progress beyond just art. The 2026 theme, "Harnessing Creativity for



Global Progress,” promotes innovative thinking in technology, entrepreneurship, and social development. The concept originated in 2002 and was formally adopted by the UN in 2017, with global observance starting in 2018. The day aligns with the Sustainable Development Goals, encouraging inclusive, resilient, and innovation-driven societies.

182. A new plant species *Stauranthera aureoglossa* has been discovered in which state?

- [A] Arunachal Pradesh
- [B] Assam
- [C] Manipur
- [D] Tripura

Answer: Arunachal Pradesh

A new plant species *Stauranthera aureoglossa* has been discovered in Arunachal Pradesh. It grows in mid-elevation evergreen forests of Kamle and Upper Subansiri districts. The plant is a perennial herb found on damp rocks near streams and rivulets. It has a bell-shaped, bluish-purple flower with no basal spur (tubular projection). A unique yellow, tongue-like patch is present inside the flower. The term “aureoglossa” means golden tongue, describing this feature. Leaves are diamond or spear-shaped.

183. Áspero, that was recently seen in news, is a Late Preceramic site located in which country?

- [A] Greece
- [B] Peru
- [C] Chile
- [D] China

Answer: Peru

Archaeologists discovered a sky-observation structure at Áspero, revealing early scientific practices. Áspero is a Late Preceramic site of the Norte Chico (Caral-Supe) civilization, one of the oldest in the Americas. It is located in Peru near the Supe River, close to the Pacific Ocean. It flourished during the Late Archaic period (before 3000 Before Christ (BC) to around 1800 BC). It was a major fishing, trade, and urban centre linked to Caral. The site has platform mounds and sunken plazas showing advanced planning.

184. Technology Development and Investment Promotion (TDIP) Scheme has been launched by which organization?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India
- [B] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] Department of Telecommunications

Answer: Department of Telecommunications

The Union Minister of Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia launched revised guidelines for the Technology Development and Investment Promotion (TDIP) Scheme. The Technology Development and Investment Promotion (TDIP) Scheme has been launched by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) to boost global telecom standardization. It has an outlay of ₹203 crore for 2026–2031. It supports India’s participation in global bodies like International



Telecommunication Union, 3GPP (Third Generation Partnership Project). It funds global meetings, technical contributions, and leadership roles.

185. "VM Frames" initiative has been launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Information & Broadcasting
- [B] Ministry of Culture
- [C] Ministry of Education
- [D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Ministry of Culture

The Ministry of Culture launched "VM Frames" filmmaking competition to mark 150 years of Vande Mataram. The national song was written by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay and symbolizes India's freedom struggle. The initiative is part of year-long celebrations led by the Government of India. VM Frames invites citizens to express themes of patriotism, unity, and cultural identity. Categories include Reels, Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based Films, and Short Films. Total prize pool is up to ₹50 lakh across categories. It aims to engage youth and creators in storytelling about New India.

186. The historic city of Dhar, recently selected under the Safe Cities project, is located in which state?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Madhya Pradesh
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Madhya Pradesh

Dhar city of Madhya Pradesh has been selected under the Safe Cities Project 2026 to enhance women's safety. The initiative is led by the Ministry of Women and Child Development and fully funded by the Central Government. An allocation of ₹10 crore has been made for a 5-year implementation period. It aims to make public spaces safer and women-friendly through infrastructure upgrades.

187. Which district of Maharashtra secured first rank in the country for awareness activities under the 8th National Nutrition Fortnight campaign?

- [A] Pune
- [B] Nagpur
- [C] Ahilyanagar
- [D] Nashik

Answer: Ahilyanagar

Ahilyanagar district ranked 1st in India for activities under the National Nutrition Fortnight campaign. It recorded 3,24,075 awareness activities, the highest in the country. Pune district secured 2nd position nationwide. The campaign is conducted by the Women and Child Development Department. It is part of the National Nutrition Fortnight (Poshan Pakhwada) initiative. The theme is "Brain Development in the First Six Years of a Child's Life."

188. Mookambika Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?



- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Karnataka

Sewage from tourism in Kollur is threatening Mookambika Wildlife Sanctuary, with pollution entering via the Souparnika River. It is located in Udupi district of Karnataka in the Western Ghats. The sanctuary covers about 370 square kilometres and is biodiversity-rich. It is named after the Kollur Mookambika Temple deity within its boundaries. It forms an ecological link between Someshwara Wildlife Sanctuary (south) and Sharavathi Wildlife Sanctuary (north).

189. Which city is the host of 2027 World Para Athletics Championships?

- [A] Paris
- [B] Beijing
- [C] New Delhi
- [D] Tashkent

Answer: Tashkent

World Para Athletics announced that Tashkent will host the 2027 World Para Athletics Championships. It will be the 13th edition and the first time Central Asia hosts the event. The championship will be held at the Olympic City Main Stadium in Tashkent. It is governed by the International Paralympic Committee. The event features top para-athletes from across the world. It serves as a qualification pathway for the Paralympic Games.

190. Myiophanes kempii, a rare thread-legged assassin bug, was rediscovered after nearly 100 years in which region?

- [A] Western Ghats
- [B] Sundarbans
- [C] Andaman Islands
- [D] Thar Desert

Answer: Andaman Islands

The rare, thread-legged assassin bug *Myiophanes kempii* was recently rediscovered in the limestone caves of the Andaman Islands after nearly a century-long gap. British entomologist William Edward China first described the species in 1924 after finding it in the Siju Cave of Meghalaya. It is a member of the Reduviidae family, a group of insects popularly known as assassin bugs due to their predatory nature. The insect is a specialized cave-dweller that spends its entire lifecycle in complete darkness within subterranean ecosystems. It features a slender body and elongated legs that are specifically adapted for navigating and surviving in cave environments.

191. Which state is the largest producer of Jamun (genus *Syzygium*), that was recently mentioned in news?

- [A] Kerala



- [B] Odisha
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Maharashtra

India has emerged as the evolutionary cradle of Jamun (genus *Syzygium*), with origins tracing back about 80 million years. Earlier, Jamun was believed to have originated in Australia or Southeast Asia, but new research suggests an East Gondwanan origin with early presence in India. Jamun belongs to the family Myrtaceae and is also known as black plum or Indian black cherry. It is native to the Indian subcontinent and widely distributed across Asia and Australia. India is a leading producer, with Maharashtra topping production. Bahadoli Jamun received GI tag in 2024, and cultivation is expanding across several states.

192. Online Gaming Authority of India (OGAI) functions under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- [C] Ministry of Finance
- [D] Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

Answer: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

The Government of India has recently established the Online Gaming Authority of India (OGAI) under the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025 to regulate the growing online gaming sector. It functions under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) and become operational from May 1, 2026. The authority will act as a central regulator for online games, including esports, by introducing a system for registration and classification. It will determine whether a game qualifies as a money game and handle public grievances related to online gaming.

193. Santiaguito Volcano, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] China
- [B] Malaysia
- [C] Guatemala
- [D] Indonesia

Answer: Guatemala

The Santiaguito Volcano is an active volcano located in western Guatemala near the city of Quetzaltenango. It was formed after the major 1902 eruption of the Santa María Volcano. It consists of a lava-dome complex and is among the most active volcanic regions in the world. The volcano frequently emits ash and smoke, indicating continuous volcanic activity. Occasionally, it produces lava flows and dangerous pyroclastic flows. Recently, an eruption forced hikers to flee as rocks and volcanic material were ejected into the air.

194. A new fanged frog species named *Limnonectes motijheel* was recently discovered in which state?

- [A] Tripura
- [B] Assam



[C] Manipur

[D] Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: Arunachal Pradesh

Recently, Indian scientists discovered a new fanged frog species named *Limnonectes motijheel* in the Namdapha Tiger Reserve, Arunachal Pradesh, highlighting rich biodiversity in Northeast India. It is a newly identified species belonging to the genus *Limnonectes*, which now has six known species in India. The frog is named after Motijheel Lake, an area known for high amphibian diversity. It belongs to the group called fanged frogs, where males possess small fang-like projections in the lower jaw, possibly used for feeding or territorial behaviour. These frogs are generally found across South and Southeast Asia and show unique reproductive traits.

195. Sugor Tso Lake, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

[A] Manipur

[B] Tripura

[C] Arunachal Pradesh

[D] Assam

Answer: Arunachal Pradesh

Sugor Tso is a high-altitude dual lake system located in the Upper Siang district, Arunachal Pradesh, within the Eastern Himalayan region. It consists of Upper Sugor Tso and Sugor Tso, which are hydrologically connected and fed by the Sugor stream. The lake lies in the Eastern Himalayan biodiversity hotspot, known for rich flora, fauna, and fragile ecosystems. It is formed in natural mountain depressions, receiving water from streams, rainfall, and snowmelt. Due to its remote location and difficult terrain, access is limited, which has helped preserve its natural condition.

196. What is the theme of the Chintan Shivir organized by Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment?

[A] Sabka Saath Sabka Vikas

[B] Digital India

[C] Antyodaya ka Sankalp, Amrit Kaal ka Pratibimb

[D] Skill India Mission

Answer: Antyodaya ka Sankalp, Amrit Kaal ka Pratibimb

Recently, the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment organised a three-day Chintan Shivir (April 24–26, 2026) in Chandigarh on the theme “Antyodaya ka Sankalp, Amrit Kaal ka Pratibimb – Viksit Bharat @2047”. The objective is to strengthen social justice schemes, improve last-mile delivery, and create a roadmap for inclusive empowerment of marginalised communities. The Shivir focuses on best practices, gap analysis, and actionable recommendations (short-, medium-, long-term). It aims to enhance coordination, digital governance, and community participation in achieving Viksit Bharat @2047.

197. World Book and Copyright Day is observed on which day every year?

[A] April 22



[B] April 23

[C] April 24

[D] April 25

Answer: April 23

World Book and Copyright Day is observed on 23 April every year to promote reading, books, and copyright awareness worldwide. The date is linked to literary figures like William Shakespeare and Miguel de Cervantes. It was officially declared by UNESCO in 1995. Rabat is the World Book Capital for 2026, promoting literacy, multilingualism, and access to books. The day highlights the importance of reading culture, cultural exchange, and protection of authors' rights in a knowledge-based society.

198. Which country has built the world's first permanent deep geological repository for nuclear waste?

[A] Spain

[B] China

[C] Finland

[D] Malaysia

Answer: Finland

Finland has built the world's first permanent deep geological repository for nuclear waste at Olkiluoto. The facility, called Onkalo repository, is located about 400–450 metres underground in stable bedrock. It is designed to safely store highly radioactive spent nuclear fuel for tens of thousands of years. The system uses a multi-barrier approach: waste sealed in metal canisters, enclosed in copper capsules, surrounded by bentonite clay, and embedded in rock. The deep underground location protects it from environmental risks and human interference.

199. Which fintech company has become the first to join RBI's Centralised Payment System (CPS)?

[A] PhonePe

[B] Razorpay

[C] MobiKwik

[D] Pay Point India Network

Answer: Pay Point India Network

In April 2026, Pay Point India Network became the first private fintech company to gain membership in the Centralised Payment System (CPS) of the Reserve Bank of India. Earlier, CPS access was limited to banks and institutions like National Payments Corporation of India and Clearing Corporation of India Limited. This move allows Pay Point direct access to payment systems such as Real Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) and National Electronic Funds Transfer (NEFT). It reduces dependence on partner banks for transactions and settlements. The company has also been assigned its own Indian Financial System Code (IFSC), enabling it to hold accounts directly with RBI.

200. Lower Lake (Chhota Talaab), that was recently seen in news, is located in which city?

[A] Bhopal

[B] Mumbai



[C] Chennai

[D] Hyderabad

Answer: Bhopal

Recently, the National Green Tribunal directed the Madhya Pradesh Pollution Control Board to inspect the Lower Lake and submit a detailed report. The Lower Lake (Chhota Talaab) is a man-made lake located in Bhopal. It was built in 1794 by Chote Khan, a minister of Nawab Hayat Muhammad Khan. Along with the Upper Lake (Bada Talaab), it forms the Bhoj Wetland, which is a Ramsar site. The Lower Lake lies east of the Upper Lake and is separated by the Pul Pukhta (Lower Lake Bridge). Both lakes are arranged in a terraced system, with interconnected water levels.

201. Kheoni Wildlife Sanctuary, where the honey badger (Ratel) was recently spotted, is located in which state?

[A] Rajasthan

[B] Gujarat

[C] Madhya Pradesh

[D] Uttar Pradesh

Answer: Madhya Pradesh

Recently, the presence of the honey badger (ratel) was confirmed in the Kheoni Wildlife Sanctuary. The honey badger is a small but extremely strong mammal belonging to the weasel family. It has a wide distribution across sub-Saharan Africa, West Asia, and the Indian subcontinent. Kheoni Wildlife Sanctuary is located in Madhya Pradesh and is connected to Ratapani Tiger Reserve via wildlife corridors.

202. International Seed Day is celebrated on which day every year?

[A] April 24

[B] April 25

[C] April 26

[D] April 27

Answer: April 26

International Seed Day is celebrated on 26 April every year to promote seed sovereignty, biodiversity conservation, and farmers' rights. It also recalls concerns over corporate control of seeds, particularly linked to Iraqi Order 81. In 2026, the focus is on local climate-resilient seeds and their role in tackling climate change. Traditional varieties like tangrashal paddy (West Bengal) and toor (red gram) in Maharashtra are highlighted. The day emphasises the role of pastoralists as custodians of biodiversity, helping in seed dispersal across regions.

203. Clouded Boghawker and Siang Boghawker, that were recently seen in news, belongs to which species?

[A] Spider

[B] Frog

[C] Honey bee

[D] Dragonfly

**Answer: Dragonfly**

Recently, scientists discovered three new species of dragonflies in Northeast India, highlighting the region's rich biodiversity. Two species—Clouded Boghawker (*Sarasaeschna nuboides*) and Siang Boghawker (*Sarasaeschna sigotaayo*)—were found in the Siang Valley of Arunachal Pradesh near forest ponds. The third species—Long-tailed Boghawker (*Sarasaeschna dosdewaensis*)—was discovered in Karimganj district, an emerging odonate diversity hotspot. Dragonflies belong to the order Odonata and are known for large compound eyes, two pairs of wings, and elongated bodies. They are fast-flying predators, feeding on insects like mosquitoes and flies.

204. Where was Asia's first UNESCO Chair on Gender Inclusion and Skill Development for Women's Empowerment launched?

- [A] Pune
- [B] New Delhi
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Chennai

Answer: Pune

Asia's first UNESCO Chair on Gender Inclusion and Skill Development for Women's Empowerment was launched at Symbiosis Skills and Professional University (SSPU) in Pune. The initiative was launched during an international conference organised with UNESCO on "Women Leading the Future of Work." It aims to promote women's participation in emerging sectors such as Artificial Intelligence, semiconductors, robotics, and advanced manufacturing. The initiative focuses on inclusive skilling, gender equity, and workforce transformation

205. Recently, India launched indigenously developed Silicon Photonics solutions at which institute?

- [A] IIT Ahmedabad
- [B] IIT Bombay
- [C] IIT Madras
- [D] IIT Roorkee

Answer: IIT Madras

Recently, India launched indigenously developed Silicon Photonics solutions at Indian Institute of Technology Madras, marking progress in technological self-reliance. The launch was led by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. Two key innovations were introduced: Silicon Photonics Process Design Kit (PDK) and Programmable Photonic Integrated Circuit (PPIC) Test Engine. These were developed at the Centre of Excellence for Compound Photonics and Photonic Integrated Circuits Systems (CoE-CPPICS). The initiative supports research, industry, startups, and defence sectors as a shared national facility.

206. The Atlas Drone Swarm System was developed by which country?

- [A] China
- [B] Israel



[C] Iran

[D] France

Answer: China

Recently, China unveiled the Atlas Drone Swarm System, an advanced military technology. It is a mobile drone swarm unit capable of launching and controlling nearly 100 drones with a single operator. It was developed by China Electronic Technology Group Corporation. The system integrates artificial intelligence with swarm technology for coordinated operations. It functions as a mini battlefield network on wheels, enabling rapid deployment.

207. In which city of Uttar Pradesh has Rocklink India established its lithium-ion battery and rare earth magnet recycling plant?

[A] Sonbhadra

[B] Meerut

[C] Raebareli

[D] Sikandrabad

Answer: Sikandrabad

Recently, Rocklink India Pvt. Ltd. set up an integrated recycling facility in Sikandrabad UPSIDC Industrial Area, Uttar Pradesh. The plant focuses on recycling lithium-ion batteries, rare earth magnets, and metal-bearing industrial waste. It has a capacity of 10,000 tonnes/year for lithium-ion batteries and 60 tonnes/month for rare-earth magnets. A rare-earth chloride processing unit (1,500 tonnes/year) is planned for 2026. The initiative supports domestic recovery of critical minerals and promotes a circular economy.

208. Which municipal corporation won the 4th Gender Equality Mobilisation (GEM) Award?

[A] Chennai Municipal Corporation

[B] Guntur Municipal Corporation

[C] Lucknow Municipal Corporation

[D] Pune Municipal Corporation

Answer: Guntur Municipal Corporation

Recently, the Guntur Municipal Corporation won UNIDO's 4th Gender Equality Mobilisation (GEM) Award in Vienna. The award was presented by United Nations Industrial Development Organization during the International Day of Women in Industry 2026. GMC was recognised for deploying 200+ women as electric auto drivers for door-to-door garbage collection. The initiative promotes women empowerment and zero-emission waste management under the Sustainable Cities Integrated Approach Pilot (SCIAP).

209. Which country has discovered a new lunar mineral named Cerium-Magnesium Changesite?

[A] Indonesia

[B] France

[C] India

[D] China

Answer: China

China has announced the discovery of a new lunar mineral named Cerium-Magnesium



Changesite, adding to knowledge of extraterrestrial materials and lunar geology. The mineral was identified in a lunar meteorite called Pakepake 005, the first such meteorite found in China. This meteorite is a small spherical rock weighing about 44 grams with a dark molten outer layer. The mineral itself is colourless, transparent, and brittle, yet scientifically significant. It shows fluorescent properties, meaning it can emit light under certain conditions. This fluorescence has potential applications in advanced technologies like next-generation LED materials.

210. Pykara Lake, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Tamil Nadu

The Madras High Court has refused to lift the temporary ban on boating in Pykara Lake, highlighting environmental concerns. Pykara Lake is located in the Nilgiri district of Tamil Nadu and was formed by the construction of a dam on the Pykara River. The river originates from Mukurthi Peak and is the largest river in the district. It is considered sacred by the Toda tribe, an indigenous Adivasi community. The Pykara Dam hosts one of the oldest hydropower plants in South India, generating about 60 MW of electricity.

211. The report "Moving Towards Effective City Government – A Framework for Million-plus Cities" was released by which institution?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Reserve Bank of India
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] World Bank

Answer: NITI Aayog

The NITI Aayog released the report "Moving Towards Effective City Government – A Framework for Million-plus Cities" at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi, by Union Minister Manohar Lal Khattar. The report highlights that urbanisation is key to achieving Viksit Bharat 2047 and a \$30 trillion economy, but cities face issues like weak governance, low financial autonomy, and fragmented institutions. It stresses empowering city governments as engines of economic growth, innovation, and employment. It suggests integrating urban services (water, sanitation, transport) under city authorities for better coordination.

212. Who won the Under-17 Boys National title at the 87th Inter-State Junior and Youth National Table Tennis Championships?

- [A] Sarthak Arya
- [B] Ritvik Gupta
- [C] Sharath Kamal
- [D] Manav Thakkar

Answer: Ritvik Gupta



Ritvik Gupta from Jammu and Kashmir won the Under-17 Boys National title at the 87th Inter-State Junior and Youth National Table Tennis Championships. The championship was organised under the Table Tennis Federation of India and held in Dehradun. In the final, he defeated Sarthak Arya of Odisha in a close 4–3 match. Ritvik became the first player from Jammu & Kashmir to win a national U-17 boys title in table tennis.

213. Diphtheria disease, that was recently seen in news, is caused by which agent?

- [A] Bacteria
- [B] Virus
- [C] Fungus
- [D] Protozoa

Answer: Bacteria

Diphtheria is re-emerging in parts of Australia despite being largely controlled earlier, raising public health concerns. It is a highly contagious bacterial infection caused by *Corynebacterium diphtheriae*, which produces a harmful toxin. The disease mainly affects the upper respiratory tract, especially the throat, nose, and tonsils, and sometimes the skin. It spreads through respiratory droplets or contact with infected wounds, and even asymptomatic individuals can transmit it.

214. Luzon Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Indonesia
- [B] China
- [C] Russia
- [D] Philippines

Answer: Philippines

China conducted military drills, including live-fire exercises, near Luzon Island, highlighting regional strategic tensions. Luzon is the largest and most important island of the Philippines, located in its northern part. It hosts over half of the country's population, making it the political and economic centre. The capital city Manila is situated on Luzon. The island is bordered by the Philippine Sea (east), South China Sea (west), and Sibuyan Sea (south). The Luzon Strait lies to its north, separating it from Taiwan.

215. What is the name of the heritage designer collection launched recently by Central Cottage Industries Corporation of India (CCIC)?

- [A] Kala Sutra
- [B] Soul Threads
- [C] Vastra Bharat
- [D] Heritage Loom

Answer: Soul Threads

The Central Cottage Industries Corporation of India launched its first heritage designer collection Soul Threads, marking a revival of India's artisanal promotion efforts. Soul Threads is a curated initiative showcasing handloom, handicrafts, designer fashion, and cultural performances. The aim is to preserve and promote India's textile heritage while providing a platform for artisans, designers, and folk artists. It supports the handloom



and handicraft economy by connecting traditional craftsmanship with modern markets.

216. India's first anode material production facility for lithium-ion batteries has been commissioned in which state?

- [A] West Bengal
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Bihar
- [D] Jharkhand

Answer: West Bengal

Himadri Speciality Chemical Limited commissioned India's first anode material production facility in April 2026 at Mahistikry Hooghly, West Bengal, with an initial capacity of 200 MTPA. The facility marks India's entry into the lithium-ion battery value chain, crucial for EVs, energy storage, and electronics. Himadri produces both anode and cathode materials, which together account for ~65% of battery cost. The site is being developed into an integrated hub with total carbon black capacity of 250,000 MTPA, including speciality carbon black production.

217. What is the name of the app launched by Union Youth Affairs and Sports Minister for athlete management in shooting?

- [A] Khelo India App
- [B] NRAI Athlete App
- [C] Sports India App
- [D] Fit India App

Answer: NRAI Athlete App

Union Youth Affairs and Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya attended the 75th anniversary of the National Rifle Association of India. He launched a nationwide grassroots programme to introduce 7.5 lakh school and college students to shooting. The programme is based on a "10-shot experience" to promote early exposure to the sport. It aims to prepare young talent for the 2028 Summer Olympics. The initiative will be implemented with institutions like Central Board of Secondary Education and Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan. A digital platform called NRAI Athlete App was launched for athlete registration, certification, and performance tracking.

218. Where was National Deliberative Summit on "Harmonizing Administrative Data for Governance" held?

- [A] Mumbai
- [B] Bhubaneswar
- [C] Chennai
- [D] Bhopal

Answer: Bhubaneswar

Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation hosted a National Deliberative Summit on "Harmonizing Administrative Data for Governance" in Bhubaneswar. The summit follows the Fifth National Conference of Chief Secretaries (2025). It aims to improve evidence-based policymaking and service delivery using administrative data.



States and Union Territories assessed readiness through consultations.

219. Which state government launched a Mushroom Mission to become India's top mushroom producer?

- [A] Andhra Pradesh
- [B] Bihar
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

The Andhra Pradesh government led by N. Chandrababu Naidu is launching a Mushroom Mission with an estimated investment of ₹13,000 crore. The mission aims to make Andhra Pradesh the largest mushroom producer in India, targeting 67,500 tonnes annually. It seeks to surpass Bihar, which currently produces about 45,000 tonnes. The initiative will promote small and medium units (around 5,000 sq ft) to boost rural employment and entrepreneurship. The mission also aims to enhance exports, especially to Gulf countries, and build a strong agri-value chain.

220. Which country topped the medal tally at the ISSF Junior World Cup Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun held in Cairo?

- [A] India
- [B] Indonesia
- [C] Singapore
- [D] Myanmar

Answer: India

India finished top of the medal tally at the ISSF Junior World Cup Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun held in Cairo. The Indian team won a total of 16 medals, including 5 gold, 6 silver, and 5 bronze. The event highlighted strong performance by Indian junior shooters at the global level. Indian athletes will next participate in the ISSF Junior World Championship in Germany.

221. Who became the first athlete to run a sub-two-hour marathon in legal race conditions at the 2026 London Marathon?

- [A] Eliud Kipchoge
- [B] Kenenisa Bekele
- [C] Sebastian Sawe
- [D] Mo Farah

Answer: Sebastian Sawe

Sebastian Sawe became the first athlete to run a sub-two-hour marathon in legal race conditions at the 2026 London Marathon. He completed the marathon (42.195 km) in 1 hour 59 minutes 30 seconds, setting a new men's world record (subject to ratification by World Athletics). His average pace was 2 minutes 49.9 seconds per kilometre, with an average speed of 21.2 km/h. He maintained an average 100 m split of 16.9 seconds and a mile pace of 4 minutes 33 seconds. His performance included a negative split, meaning he ran the second half faster than the first.

222. The World Day for Safety and Health at Work is celebrated annually on which day?



- [A] April 27
- [B] April 28
- [C] April 29
- [D] April 30

Answer: April 28

The World Day for Safety and Health at Work (World OSH Day) is celebrated annually on April 28 by the International Labour Organization (ILO) to promote safe, healthy, and decent work. It focuses on preventing work-related accidents and diseases, raising awareness, and fostering a positive safety culture. The 2026 theme focuses on "Good psychosocial working environments: A pathway to thriving workers and strong organization," addressing issues like workload, stress, and burnout.

223. India won which medal in women's kabaddi competition at the Asian Beach Games 2026?

- [A] Gold medal
- [B] Silver medal
- [C] Bronze medal
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Gold medal

India won gold medal in women's kabaddi and silver in men's kabaddi at the Asian Beach Games 2026 held in Sanya. The Indian women's team defeated Sri Lanka 47-31 in the final to win the gold medal. This is India's first gold medal in the current edition of the games. The Indian men's team lost to Iran 31-44 and secured the silver medal. The event is organised by the Olympic Council of Asia. In the 2016 edition, India won 24 medals (2 gold, 4 silver, 18 bronze).

224. Nubra, Sham, Changthang, Zaskar, and Drass have been approved as new districts of which State/Union Territory?

- [A] Jammu and Kashmir
- [B] Sikkim
- [C] Himachal Pradesh
- [D] Ladakh

Answer: Ladakh

Ladakh has approved the creation of five new districts, increasing the total from 2 to 7. The new districts are Nubra, Sham, Changthang, Zaskar, and Drass. Earlier, Ladakh had only Leh and Kargil as its districts. The move was approved by the Ministry of Home Affairs under Amit Shah in August 2024. The objective is to strengthen grassroots governance, decentralise administration, and improve service delivery. It will enhance opportunities for employment, entrepreneurship, and regional development. Ladakh became a Union Territory in 2019 after the bifurcation of Jammu and Kashmir.

225. Raghu Rai, who recently passed away, was associated with which field?

- [A] Literature
- [B] Photography
- [C] Sports



[D] Politics

Answer: Photography

Raghu Rai, a legendary Indian photographer, passed away on April 26, 2026, in New Delhi at the age of 83. He was a member of Magnum Photos and a pioneer of modern Indian photojournalism. He was known for capturing iconic moments such as the Bhopal Gas Tragedy and political life in India. He documented major events including the 1971 Bangladesh War and worked closely with leaders like Indira Gandhi. He was nominated to Magnum Photos by Henri Cartier-Bresson in 1977. He was awarded the Padma Shri in 1972.

226. A fossil bed from the Holocene epoch was recently discovered in which state?

[A] Tamil Nadu

[B] Karnataka

[C] Kerala

[D] Maharashtra

Answer: Tamil Nadu

A fossil bed from the Holocene epoch was discovered in Thoothukudi after heavy rains in 2023 exposed the site. The Holocene is part of the Quaternary period. The discovery will help scientists better understand India's ancient wildlife, climate, and environmental conditions. A field survey was conducted by the Zoological Survey of India at the request of local authorities. The discovery highlights the importance of geological studies in reconstructing past ecosystems.

227. Siang Upper Multipurpose Project is located in which state?

[A] Arunachal Pradesh

[B] Assam

[C] Sikkim

[D] Manipur

Answer: Arunachal Pradesh

The Siang Upper Multipurpose Project is a proposed 11,000 Megawatt hydropower project on the Siang River near Geku village in Upper Siang district, Arunachal Pradesh. The Siang River is the upper course of the Brahmaputra River, making the project strategically significant. The project is envisioned as one of India's largest hydropower reservoirs. It also serves as a strategic response to China's proposed dam on the Yarlung Tsangpo. The project is being developed by National Hydroelectric Power Corporation and North Eastern Electric Power Corporation.

228. A rare orchid species named *Eulophia picta* was recently discovered in which state?

[A] Kerala

[B] Karnataka

[C] Maharashtra

[D] Andhra Pradesh

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

Scientists recorded a rare orchid species named *Eulophia picta* for the first time in central



Andhra Pradesh. It is a medium-to-small, hot-growing terrestrial orchid commonly called the Nodding Swamp Orchid. It is distributed from India to Southeast Asia and Australia, occurring in moist grasslands, sandy coastal areas, and rainforests. It also grows in semi-deciduous and dry lowland forests up to about 1000 m elevation.

229. Which ministry is the nodal authority for the Sahyog Portal?

- [A] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- [B] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [C] Ministry of Law and Justice
- [D] Ministry of Defence

Answer: Ministry of Home Affairs

The Delhi High Court asked the Union government whether X Corp. must join the Sahyog Portal for cases involving trafficking and national security. The Sahyog Portal is an online platform launched in 2024 to enable quick removal of illegal content from the internet. It allows government agencies to send direct takedown notices to social media platforms and intermediaries. The portal is managed by the Ministry of Home Affairs. It provides centralised communication between agencies, nodal officers, and intermediaries.

230. Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar is administered by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Education
- [B] Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
- [C] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [D] Ministry of Culture

Answer: Ministry of Women and Child Development

The Central Government has invited nominations for the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar. It is a prestigious national award given annually by the Government of India. The award is administered by the Ministry of Women and Child Development. It recognises children for excellence in Bravery, Art & Culture, Environment, Social Service, Science & Technology, and Sports. Eligible candidates must be Indian citizens aged between 5 and 18 years.

231. Lake Issyk-Kul is located in which state?

- [A] Iran
- [B] Kyrgyzstan
- [C] Uzbekistan
- [D] Israel

Answer: Kyrgyzstan

Underwater archaeologists discovered a hidden ancient city beneath Lake Issyk-Kul in Central Asia. The submerged settlement is estimated to be around 700 years old, indicating a previously unknown civilization. The discovery provides insights into historical trade routes, settlements, and cultural life in the region. Lake Issyk-Kul is located in northeastern Kyrgyzstan and is surrounded by the Tian Shan Mountains. It is an endorheic lake, meaning it has no outflow to seas or rivers. The lake contains blue, slightly saline (brackish) water. It is the second-largest high mountain lake in the world after Lake



Titicaca.

232. What is the name of the investor awareness initiative launched on the 38th Foundation Day of SEBI?

- [A] Mission Suraksha
- [B] Mission Jagrook
- [C] Mission Nivesh
- [D] Mission Arth

Answer: Mission Jagrook

Union Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman launched Mission Jagrook on April 25, 2026. It is a nationwide investor awareness initiative launched in collaboration with Securities and Exchange Board of India. The launch took place during the 38th Foundation Day of SEBI in Mumbai. The mission aims to educate retail investors about market risks and financial frauds, including AI-based deepfakes. It promotes financial literacy and safe investment practices among the public

233. Which institute has developed a smart material that can both store energy and indicate charge level through colour change?

- [A] Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences, Bengaluru
- [B] IIT Bombay
- [C] Council of Scientific & Industrial Research
- [D] Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru

Answer: Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences, Bengaluru

Scientists from Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences, Bengaluru, developed a smart material that can both store energy and indicate charge level through colour change. The material is an oxygen-deficient bimetallic oxide made of molybdenum and tungsten. It appears blue when charged and transparent when discharged, enabling real-time visual monitoring. The innovation uses oxygen vacancies to enhance ion movement and alter electronic structure. It was synthesised using the solvothermal method.

234. Which state is the host of Exercise 'Pragati' 2026?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Andhra Pradesh
- [C] Sikkim
- [D] Meghalaya

Answer: Meghalaya

The first edition of Exercise 'Pragati' is scheduled to take place at Umroi, Meghalaya, from May 18–31, 2026. Exercise Pragati (Partnership of Regional Armies for Growth and Transformation in the Indian Ocean Region) involves 11 friendly countries. It aims to enhance defence cooperation, interoperability, and mutual trust among participating nations. The exercise reflects a shared commitment to regional security and stability in the Indian Ocean Region.

235. Where is the Google Cloud India AI Hub being established?

- [A] Bengaluru



- [B] Hyderabad
- [C] Chennai
- [D] Visakhapatnam

Answer: Visakhapatnam

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu laid the foundation stone for the Google Cloud India AI Hub in Visakhapatnam. The project is part of a major collaboration involving Google Cloud, Adani Group, and Bharti Airtel. Google has committed an investment of USD 15 billion, making it one of India's largest foreign direct investments. The AI data centre will have a capacity of 1 Gigawatt and will be built over 600 acres. It will enhance India's artificial intelligence, cloud computing, and digital infrastructure.

236. The Namo Stall distribution scheme was launched by which state government in April 2026?

- [A] Jharkhand
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Bihar
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Jharkhand

Union Minister of State for Defence Sanjay Seth launched the Namo Stall distribution scheme in Ranchi, Jharkhand. The initiative aims to support street fruit and vegetable vendors by providing free stalls. In the first phase, five vendors received stalls, each costing around ₹50,000. The programme seeks to empower small traders and ensure stable livelihoods.

237. What is the theme of Fire Safety Week 2026?

- [A] Fire Free India
- [B] Safety First
- [C] Safe School, Safe Hospital and Fire Safety Aware Society
- [D] Disaster Ready India

Answer: Safe School, Safe Hospital and Fire Safety Aware Society

The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare will observe Nationwide Fire Safety Week 2026 from 4th to 10th May. The initiative focuses on strengthening fire safety in healthcare facilities across India. The theme for 2026 is "Safe School, Safe Hospital and Fire Safety Aware Society – Together for Fire Prevention." It aims to promote awareness, improve compliance, and build a safety culture among healthcare workers and the public.

238. Where was the Old Seeds Festival 2026 held?

- [A] Araku Valley, Andhra Pradesh
- [B] Dehradun, Uttarakhand
- [C] Kodaikanal, Tamil Nadu
- [D] Mussoorie, Himachal Pradesh

Answer: Araku Valley, Andhra Pradesh

The 17th Old Seeds Festival was celebrated in Araku Valley, Andhra Pradesh. It celebrates heirloom seeds, tribal heritage, and natural farming practices. The event was organised by Sanjeevini Environment Protection Society in collaboration with sustainable agriculture



organisations. The festival promotes climate-resilient indigenous seeds and sustainable agriculture. Seed Saviour Award 2026 was given to farmers preserving biodiversity.

239. The Science Panel for the Global Energy Transition (SPGET) was launched in which country?

- [A] Brazil
- [B] Australia
- [C] Germany
- [D] Colombia

Answer: Colombia

The Science Panel for the Global Energy Transition (SPGET) was launched on April 24, 2026 in Santa Marta, Colombia. It is a global science-based advisory panel aimed at accelerating the transition away from fossil fuels. The initiative emerged from discussions at COP30. Its mission is to provide fast, science-based and policy-relevant guidance to governments. It focuses on achieving climate targets aligned with limiting global warming to 1.5°C.

240. The International Day in Memory of the Victims of Earthquakes is observed annually on which day?

- [A] April 27
- [B] April 28
- [C] April 29
- [D] April 30

Answer: April 29

The International Day in Memory of the Victims of Earthquakes is observed annually on April 29. It was established by the United Nations General Assembly in 2025. The day aims to honour victims of earthquakes and support survivors. It promotes disaster resilience and preparedness worldwide. It aligns with the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015–2030. It encourages risk-informed development and safer building standards.

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